

SILVER RIDGE RAILWAY



RAILWAY HANDBOOK

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Foreword

This handbook describes a railroad that does not exist.

The Silver Ridge Railway has never carried ore down from a mine on the northwest face of any mountain. The Valley Flyer has never crossed a gorge in the autumn light, its observation platform open to the receding canyon. Pine Valley Junction is a yard built on a table in a room, and the crews who work it are, at any given moment, one person with a throttle and however much imagination they are willing to bring to the work.

What I was trying to build — what this handbook is the record of — is a place where that imagination has something to push against. A railroad with a reason to exist. Industries that depend on it. A community that would notice if it stopped running. The Valley Flyer earns its operating priority not because a rule says so, but because it matters to the people of Silver Ridge in the way that a passenger train on a small railroad matters: it is the public face of something that would otherwise be invisible. The ore trains pay the bills. The Flyer keeps the lights on in a different sense entirely.

The SRRX is set in the diesel era of the Rocky Mountain shortline — the 1970s through the 2000s, a period when railroads like this one were surviving by being stubborn and useful rather than efficient or modern. That felt like the right era for a railroad built on a mountain, serving customers that a larger carrier would have abandoned, holding on because the alternative was worse for everyone. The equipment is secondhand. The grades are steep. The crews know every curve by feel. None of that is incidental to the railroad's character — it is the character.

There are several places whose names and existence have a personal connection to me, making this railroad more than just a hobby creation. First, there is a freight car in the fleet bearing the Burlington Route logo. Growing up, there was a book on my father's bookshelf written by his uncle, Richard Carlton Overton, called The Burlington Route and carried that logo. Uncle Dick was a historian and a railroad enthusiast. This was one of a few books he wrote on railroads. That logo was superseded several times over as the Burlington Route ultimately became BNSF, the Class I that still operates today.

In a shout out to my father, also named Dick, is the bar/diner with the name Dew Drop Inn. This was the name of the bar that my father would stop by at on his way back from the NY Giants games with whoever he talked into going with him to watch Y.A. Tittle and Fran Tarkenton lead the Giants to yet another loss, coincidentally about the same time frame that I am modeling the SRRX. I believe the bar was by the river on the "other side of the tracks" in Weehawken, NJ, a very blue collar area of the Garden State.

The inspiration for Silver Ridge always was from my love for the Colorado mountains, and in particular from Steamboat Springs, where my oldest son lives with his wife and my (currently) only grandson. He is the CFO of the local community bank, the Yampa Valley Bank. Steamboat Springs is a big little town that exists mainly because the railroad came through in 1909 allowing Steamboat to export coal, shipping and receiving livestock, mineral, and other agricultural supplies. Passenger service stopped in 1968. Today freight no longer stops in Steamboat, as the Union Pacific rumbles through using the historic freight line to cross the state.

My younger son works at a large government contractor that maintains discreet offices across the world. In his honor, I have modeled a deliberately unremarkable building that no one could possibly miss, with blacked out windows, a satellite dish, an obvious government vehicle, and a barbed wire fence on a hill just outside of town.

Lastly, the gorge flagstop depot is modeled after a converted passenger car, from the late 19th century, called an Overton Coach. The name came from William Dayton Overton (no relation that I know of) who built lightweight wooden passenger cars in the 1870s-80s. They were common on short lines and narrow

gauge roads in exactly the kind of mountain territory the SRRX operates in. Somehow, it just felt right to use a car named after an Overton on this railroad, even if the connection is coincidental.

The railroad does not need these personal connections to run. But they are part of why it was worth building.

If you are reading this as a guest operator, the handbook will tell you what you need to know about how the railroad runs. The rules are in Section 7. The switching guides are in Section 8. The timetable is in the appendix. What the handbook cannot tell you is that the Mine Run is the most satisfying movement on the layout, and that the Valley Flyer crossing the gorge bridge — even at switching speed, even on a table in a room — is worth pausing for. You will figure that out on your own.

If you are reading this after I am no longer around to explain it, then I hope the railroad speaks for itself. The track plan is v10. Everything in this handbook was put there on purpose, even the things that look like workarounds. Especially those.

The Silver Ridge Railway exists because someone stood beside imaginary tracks and waited for a distant horn that would never roll through a real mountain. It turns out that is enough of a reason. Run the trains accordingly.

— *Jake Overton*

SECTION 1 – THE SILVER RIDGE RAILWAY

1.1. Overview

The Silver Ridge Railway exists for anyone who has ever stood beside the tracks and waited for the distant echo of a horn rolling through the mountains. It's a celebration of foothill towns, high timber country, deep gorges, and the stubborn little shortlines that keep them connected. This railroad is built for the railfan's eye — a place where every curve reveals a new scene, every milepost tells a story, and every train feels like it belongs in the landscape.

The Silver Ridge Railway (SRRX) is a rugged, independent mountain shortline operating in the high country of the Silver Ridge region. Its purpose is simple but essential: connect remote industries, support the local economy, and maintain a lifeline of rail access through terrain that would have driven most railroads out decades ago. The SRRX survives because it is adaptable, stubborn, and deeply rooted in the communities it serves.

The railroad's territory is shaped by dramatic geography: a looping mainline that circles the slopes of Silver Ridge Mountain, a high-elevation mine reached only by a switchback branch, and a series of narrow benches carved into the mountainside. Every mile reflects a century of compromise between geography and necessity. The SRRX is not a railroad of speed or efficiency — it is a railroad of persistence, ingenuity, and operational craft.

Today, the SRRX handles a focused mix of forest products, fuel distribution, and mineral traffic from the high-elevation Silver Ridge Mine. It also operates the Valley Flyer, a short but beloved passenger service that provides visibility, political relevance, and a steady stream of visitors who help justify the railroad's continued existence.

1.2. Founding and Early Years (1904–1930s)

The Silver Ridge Railway was incorporated in 1904 with a straightforward mandate: connect the isolated mining communities east of Silver Ridge Mountain with the Denver and Rio Grande Western and the broader rail network beyond. The D&RGW had been working the region's major corridors for three decades by then, and the SRRX was conceived from the beginning as a feeder — a shortline built to move what the mountain produced down to a railroad large enough to take it somewhere.

Construction crews spent the better part of a decade carving the line along steep hillsides, following natural contours where the terrain allowed and blasting where it did not. Progress was measured in feet rather than miles through the most demanding stretches. By 1910 the line had reached the Silver Ridge mining district, where a small tippie loaded raw ore into wooden hoppers for the descent to the D&RGW interchange. A settlement grew around the mine and the yard that served it, putting down the first roots of what would become Pine Valley Junction. From the beginning, the grades demanded more than a single locomotive could reliably provide, and a short siding — the same siding that serves today as the Helper Engine Pocket — was established early to stage helper power for the heaviest ore movements.

The railroad that emerged from those first decades was spare and purposeful, shaped entirely by the mountain it had agreed to serve. It has never entirely lost that character.

1.3. Expansion and Diversification (1940s–1960s)

As ore production from the original mining district began to decline, the region shifted its economic weight toward timber and fuel distribution, and the SRRX shifted with it. The line extended beyond Pine Valley Junction into the Timberline valley, where logging operations had been working the surrounding slopes for years without reliable rail access. Timberline Lumber and the Timberline Fuel Depot were both

established during this period, each filling a gap in the region's supply chain that trucks and mountain roads could not reliably cover year-round.

The town of Silver Ridge grew alongside these industries, drawing workers and their families into a community that the railroad connected to the outside world as much as it connected the industries to their markets. What had begun as a mining camp outpost became something more durable — a place with a main street, a school, and a reason to stay.

The original tunnel east of Pine Valley Junction was rebuilt during this era, creating the dramatic curve-and-portal geometry that still defines the line's character on that approach. The D&RGW interchange at Pine Valley Junction remained the economic foundation of everything — every outbound load and every inbound empty passed through it, as they always had. The railroad that emerged from the postwar decades was broader in purpose than the one that had been built to serve the mine, and more deeply woven into the life of the communities along its route.

1.4. Dieselization and the Modern Era (1970s–2000s)

The SRRX dieselized early relative to shortlines of its size, acquiring secondhand units from larger carriers as steam became impractical to maintain on a railroad with limited shop facilities and a demanding operating environment. The diesel units handled the Silver Ridge Mine grade more consistently than steam had managed in all but the heaviest loading conditions, though the grades remained steep enough that helpers were still required for the largest ore cuts on the branch.

Pine Valley Junction consolidated its role as the operational heart of the railroad during this period — a compact yard, a RIP track, modest headquarters facilities, and a small town center built around the rhythm of the operating day. Silver Ridge grew into the more public-facing of the two communities, its identity shaped by the national park designation that brought visitors into the region and gave the railroad a passenger service worth operating. The Valley Flyer, which began as a seasonal experiment, became a year-round institution.

The D&RGW connection at PVJ remained what it had always been — the thread connecting the SRRX to the national rail network, and the economic justification for every mile of maintained track between the interchange and the mine. The railroad and the Class I have been exchanging cars at that northwest corner of the yard for more than a century, a relationship so routine that it requires no ceremony and no acknowledgment beyond the cars themselves arriving and departing on schedule.

The SRRX that operates today is the product of all of it — the founding era's pragmatism, the postwar diversification, the dieselization that kept the railroad viable when steam would have finished it. It is a railroad that has survived by remaining useful, and it intends to keep doing so.

1.5. Mission and Identity

The SRRX's mission is to maintain reliable rail service in a region where terrain, weather, and economics all conspire against it. The railroad's identity is shaped by its geography: steep grades, narrow ledges, and a constant battle against the mountain itself. Every train is a negotiation with gravity.

The SRRX is a working railroad with a practical mindset, a small roster, and a culture built around doing more with less. Its crews are multi-skilled, its locomotives are rugged rather than glamorous, and its operations reflect a deep respect for the realities of mountain railroading.

The railroad's public identity is strongly tied to the Valley Flyer, which serves as the SRRX's most visible and politically valuable operation. While freight pays the bills, the Valley Flyer keeps the railroad in the public eye and ensures continued support from local governments and the National Park District.

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SECTION 1

1.6. Geography and Setting

The SRRX operates in a dramatic mountain environment defined by the Silver Ridge River, steep canyon walls, and a series of narrow benches carved into the mountainside. The railroad's alignment follows the river where possible, but long stretches require climbing away from the water and navigating tight ledges and switchbacks.

The railroad's most demanding territory lies on the mine branch, a steep spur that departs the yard at Pine Valley Junction, climbs on trestles and viaducts, and ascends the mountain via a series of switchbacks. This branch provides the only rail access to the Silver Ridge Mine, perched on a narrow bench carved into the mountainside high on the mountain's northwest face.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Switchback district overview
[SRRX Caption] The switchbacks allow the SRRX to gain the final elevation needed to reach the Silver Ridge Mine.

The line's mainline forms a continuous loop around the southern slope of Silver Ridge Mountain, connecting Pine Valley Junction in the west to the town of Silver Ridge in the south, crossing the dramatic Silver Ridge Gorge on the west wall, and returning through the inner tunnel to PVJ. This loop geometry gives the SRRX operational flexibility: trains may run in either direction depending on traffic needs, and the Valley Flyer can complete full scenic circuits in summer or operate shorter point-to-point runs during the off-season.

The geography is unforgiving, but it defines the railroad's character. The SRRX exists because it learned to operate within these constraints rather than against them.

1.7. The Role of the Railroad in the Region

The SRRX is more than a freight carrier — it is a critical piece of regional infrastructure. The industries it serves depend on rail access to remain viable, and the communities along the line rely on the railroad for jobs, tourism, and economic stability.

Much of the railroad's territory lies within the National Park District, which encompasses the gorge, the river valley, and the entire south slope of the mountain. Several industries — including the Timberline Lumber facility and the Silver Smelter — predate the park's designation and continue to operate under long-standing BLM leases. The Timberline Fuel Depot, while newer, exists under a modern conditional-use permit due to its essential role in supplying fuel to the mine, the railroad, and the surrounding communities.

The Valley Flyer strengthens the SRRX's political standing by providing controlled visitor access to the park. Without the SRRX, the region would face increased truck traffic, reduced industrial output, and the loss of a cultural and historical asset that has shaped the identity of Silver Ridge for generations.

1.8. The SRRX Today

The modern SRRX is a lean, focused operation with four primary freight customers: the Timberline Lumber facility, the Timberline Fuel Depot, the Silver Smelter, and the Silver Ridge Mine. Each customer presents unique operational challenges, from short industrial spurs on steep grades to the demanding geometry of the switchback district.

The railroad's locomotive fleet is small but capable, consisting of rugged road-switchers suited to mountain work. A dedicated helper and switching locomotive is based at Pine Valley Junction, pulling double duty as the yard switcher during normal operations and as the mine branch helper when ore runs are scheduled. The helper district is short but essential, reflecting the steepness of the climb and the limited adhesion available on the mountain's tight curves.

Beyond freight, the SRRX operates the Valley Flyer, a beloved passenger service running between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge — and in summer, completing the full scenic loop through the gorge and

SECTION 1

3

the National Park District. The service began as a seasonal excursion but evolved into a year-round operation serving commuters, winter sport enthusiasts, and sightseers alongside the tourists of peak season. The Valley Flyer keeps the SRRX visible to the public, the Park Service, and regional officials, ensuring continued support for the railroad's infrastructure and right-of-way.

1.9. The Future of the SRRX

The SRRX's future depends on its ability to maintain relevance in a changing economic landscape. Freight volumes fluctuate, industries evolve, and the cost of maintaining mountain railroad infrastructure continues to rise. The SRRX survives by staying adaptable, efficient, and deeply connected to the communities it serves.

The mine will not last forever, and Timberline Lumber may evolve as regional forestry patterns shift. But the Valley Flyer, the National Park District, and the communities along the line give the SRRX a purpose that extends beyond freight revenue. As long as the railroad remains a valued regional asset — economically, culturally, and historically — it will endure.

The Valley Flyer will continue to play a central role in the railroad's public identity, providing visibility and political support that freight alone cannot guarantee. The SRRX endures because it matters — to the people, to the region, and to the landscape itself.

SECTION 2 – OVERVIEW OF THE LINE

2.1. Overview of the Line

The Silver Ridge Railway operates a compact but demanding stretch of mountain railroad centered on Pine Valley Junction, the railroad's operational hub and yard. From PVJ, the mainline forms a continuous loop through the Silver Ridge region, running in either direction to serve the industries, communities, and scenic territory that define the SRRX's character. The mine branch departs from PVJ as a separate operating district, climbing the switchbacks to reach the Silver Ridge Mine on a narrow bench high on the mountain's northwest face.

The SRRX's operating territory is organized into five districts: the Pine Valley District, the Timberline District, the Silver Ridge District, the Gorge and West Wall District, and the Mine Branch District. Each district presents its own operational challenges, from tight industrial switching on steep grades to the precise train handling required in the switchback district. The railroad's small size belies the complexity of its operations, which demand careful planning, skilled crews, and a deep understanding of mountain railroading.

2.2. The Pine Valley District

The Pine Valley District encompasses Pine Valley Junction, the railroad's yard, engine house, interchange, and the immediate approach tracks on both sides of town. This is the operational heart of the SRRX. Trains are built and broken down here, locomotives are serviced at the Pine Valley Engine House, and crews begin and end their days at PVJ. The district also contains the diverging point for the mine branch and both tunnel portals that begin the mainline loop in either direction.

The interchange with the connecting Class I railroad at PVJ provides the SRRX's link to national markets. Virtually all inbound and outbound freight passes through this interchange, making it the economic foundation of the railroad's viability. Inbound traffic arrives as empty cars destined for the industries along the line; outbound traffic consists of loaded mineral cars, finished lumber products, and empty tank cars returning to the fuel supply network.

The Pine Valley District also serves as the base for the railroad's helper and switching locomotive, which pulls double duty as the yard switcher during normal operations and as the mine and smelter branch helper when ore runs are scheduled. This arrangement reflects the SRRX's practical philosophy: no locomotive sits idle when there is work to be done.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Pine Valley Junction yard and tunnel portals
[SRRX Caption] Pine Valley Junction is the operational hub of the SRRX, where the mainline loop diverges and the mine branch departs.

2.3. The Timberline District

When trains depart PVJ through the outer tunnel, they emerge on the east side of the layout and run south along the Silver Ridge River. This stretch forms the Timberline District, a comparatively gentle and scenic segment of the line where the river runs close to the track and the lower slopes of Silver Ridge Mountain rise to the west.

The Timberline Lumber facility occupies a gravel pad above the mainline, reached by a short climbing spur that crosses and then follows the river north before ascending to the reload site at approximately 2.5 inches of elevation. Dimensional lumber and other forest products arrive by truck from surrounding forests and are consolidated here for rail shipment outbound to the interchange at PVJ. The spur's grade requires careful car handling and disciplined brake management during switching.

The Timberline District also marks the beginning of the National Park corridor, where the SRRX operates under heightened environmental and visibility requirements. The railroad's presence here is a legacy of its founding era, maintained today through long-standing agreements with the Park Service.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Timberline District along the east wall
[SRRX Caption] The Timberline District follows the Silver Ridge River south from PVJ, with the lumber reload spur climbing above the mainline to its gravel pad.

2.4. The Silver Ridge District

At the south end of the modeled territory, the mainline reaches Silver Ridge, the largest community on the line and the SRRX's primary passenger hub. The track here forms a loop with a passing siding, allowing trains to meet, run around, or stage while serving the town. Silver Ridge sits on the valley floor with the river nearby and the mountain rising to the north, giving the town a comparatively open and accessible feel after the tight confines of the gorge and the upper districts.

The Silver Ridge depot serves the Valley Flyer and provides a focal point for the town's connection to the railroad. Most of Silver Ridge's residents rely on the SRRX in some form — whether as a commuter connection to PVJ and the industries to the north, as a gateway to the National Park District, or simply as the backbone of the regional economy that has sustained the community for generations. The town itself has more layers than its size suggests — a commercial main street with genuine working businesses, a civic block anchoring the center, and residential streets that spread toward the trailheads and the river. A full account of Silver Ridge's community character is in Section 5.

The passing siding at Silver Ridge is operationally significant. It allows the Valley Flyer to meet freight movements without delaying either service, and provides a layover point for the passenger consist between runs. In winter, when the Valley Flyer operates point-to-point rather than as a full loop, Silver Ridge is typically one terminus of the shorter service.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Silver Ridge town loop and passing siding
[SRRX Caption] Silver Ridge anchors the south end of the modeled territory, with the passing siding supporting meets between the Valley Flyer and freight movements.

2.5. The Gorge and West Wall District

North of Silver Ridge, the mainline curves along the west wall and climbs toward the Silver Ridge Gorge. This stretch is scenic and operationally straightforward — continuous mainline running with no switching required — but the terrain grows increasingly dramatic as the track approaches the gorge. The river, which has followed the railroad at a gentle distance through the lower valley, narrows and deepens here, carving the steep canyon walls that give the region its name.

At the north approach to the gorge, where the National Park District boundary becomes visible from the train, a stone-based entry sign marks the transition into protected territory. Passengers on the Valley Flyer's full-loop service can see the sign from the left side of the consist as the train rounds the curve toward the bridge. Just south of the bridge on the gorge approach, a short stub siding off the mainline serves as the Gorge Flagstop — a seasonal stop on the Valley Flyer's summer loop operation. The Gorge-ous Grub, a converted SRRX caboose on the stub track, provides refreshment for passengers who step off to take in the gorge views. See Sections 5.4 and 6.4 for details.

The gorge is crossed on a high steel bridge, with the river far below and cliffs rising on either side. This crossing is the signature scenic highlight of the Valley Flyer and a place where freight crews must respect strict speed limits and braking requirements. High winds, seasonal ice, and the exposed geometry of the bridge demand careful train handling from every crew that crosses it.

North of the gorge, the mainline passes the Timberline Fuel Depot, situated within the National Park boundary and operating under long-standing conditional-use agreements. The fuel depot spur is short and demand careful handling because of its hazardous materials protocols.

2.6. The West Approach to Pine Valley Junction

After passing the fuel depot, the mainline enters the inner tunnel and curves back toward Pine Valley Junction. The tunnel exits on the west slope of the mountain, passing under the mine branch before descending into the PVJ yard approach. This stretch completes the mainline loop and brings trains back to the operational hub from which they departed.

The west approach also functions as a transition zone for the Valley Flyer, which may load or unload passengers here depending on schedule and direction of travel. The proximity to PVJ and the interchange makes this area a natural point for transferring goods and supplies by truck for distribution beyond the rail network.

2.7. The Mine Branch District

The mine branch departs Pine Valley Junction at the yard, immediately climbing on trestles and viaducts as it gains elevation above the mainline. Before the switchbacks begin, a spur off the mine branch serves the Silver Ridge Smelter, the processing facility where ore is reduced before shipment. The smelter sits on the slope below the mine, connected to it by the same branch that serves them both.

The mine branch is the most demanding operating territory on the SRRX. Train lengths are short, grades are steep, and the switchback geometry requires precise coordination between crew members and strict adherence to operating rules. Loaded ore cuts descend under the control of the road locomotive alone, relying on dynamic braking and careful speed management to maintain safe control on the steep grades. The helper and switching locomotive, based at PVJ, assists full ore cuts on the climb to the smelter.

The mine itself sits on a narrow bench carved into the mountainside at the end of the upper switchback leg. Loading tracks are short and require trains to be broken into smaller cuts for efficient positioning under the loader. Every trip to the mine is a negotiation with gravity, geometry, and the limits of adhesion — a daily test of the SRRX's equipment, its crews, and its claim to be a railroad built for this mountain.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Mine branch climbing above the PVJ yard
[SRRX Caption] The mine branch departs PVJ on trestles and viaducts, climbing the northwest face of Silver Ridge Mountain to the switchback district and the mine beyond.

2.8. Operational Philosophy

The SRRX's operating philosophy is built around safety, efficiency, and respect for the mountain environment. Crews are trained to anticipate changing conditions, manage train handling on steep grades, and work collaboratively to keep operations fluid on a single-track mountain railroad.

The railroad's small size concentrates rather than simplifies its operations. Every movement interacts with the others, and every decision in the yard or on the branch affects how smoothly trains circulate through the mainline districts. The helper locomotive's dual role as yard switcher and mine branch helper exemplifies this philosophy: on the SRRX, versatility is not a luxury — it is a survival strategy.

Above all, the SRRX values precision and professionalism. From the first switching move of the day at PVJ to the final descent of a loaded ore cut from the mine, every action reflects the railroad's commitment to safe, effective mountain railroading.

SECTION 3 – INDUSTRIES AND TRAFFIC

3.1. Overview of SRRX Traffic

The Silver Ridge Railway handles a focused but demanding mix of traffic driven by the industries along its route. Every customer is essential. Remove any one of them and the railroad's economic viability becomes precarious. Together they create a balanced, interdependent traffic base that reflects the realities of a mountain shortline: no single revenue stream is large enough to sustain the railroad alone, but in combination they justify every mile of maintained track and every crew hour worked.

The SRRX's traffic flows in two broad categories. Outbound loads — ore from the mine, refined product from the smelter, lumber from Timberline — move to the interchange at Pine Valley Junction for forwarding on the connecting Class I railroad. Inbound empties return over the same route, along with inbound tank cars for the fuel depot and occasional carloads of supplies and equipment for the industries and communities along the line. The balance between these flows shapes train makeup, helper requirements, and the daily operating plan.

Passenger traffic, while not a primary revenue source, is woven into the operational fabric of the railroad through the Valley Flyer. Its schedule influences freight dispatching, its consist requires careful handling on the grades, and its continued operation is essential to the political relationships that keep the SRRX's right-of-way intact through the National Park District. The Valley Flyer is treated in full in Section 6; its role in the traffic balance is noted here.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — SRRX traffic flow overview
[SRRX Caption] Outbound loads and inbound empties form the backbone of SRRX operations, with the Valley Flyer woven into the daily schedule.

3.2. Timberline Lumber

Timberline Lumber occupies a gravel pad above the mainline on the east run of the line, reached by a short climbing spur that crosses and follows the Silver Ridge River north before ascending to the facility site at approximately 2.5 inches of elevation. The site is compact but purposeful: a saw shed, a log deck, a lumber storage area, and just enough room to spot a small cut of cars for loading.

Raw logs arrive by truck from the surrounding forests, hauled down from active cutting areas on the mountain slopes above. The on-site mill processes them into dimensional lumber and rough-cut timber — not a full industrial operation, but sufficient to convert raw timber into a shippable product. Finished lumber departs by rail in centerbeam flats and boxcars, moving to the interchange at PVJ for distribution to markets beyond the mountains.

The spur's grade requires disciplined car handling. Crews must maintain control during switching, applying hand brakes carefully and keeping cuts short to avoid overrunning the limited space on the pad. In wet or icy conditions the grade demands additional caution, and helpers may remain attached during switching if the locomotive is working a heavier cut.

Timberline Lumber is one of the SRRX's oldest customers, its history intertwined with the logging operations that shaped the region long before the National Park District was established. The facility predates the park's creation and continues to operate under a grandfathered BLM lease, a legacy arrangement that requires careful stewardship of the surrounding landscape as a condition of continued operation.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Timberline Lumber facility and spur
[SRRX Caption] The Timberline Lumber spur climbs above the mainline to a compact mill site where logs arrive by truck and finished lumber departs by rail.

3.3. Timberline Fuel Depot

The Timberline Fuel Depot sits on comparatively level ground on the west run of the mainline, north of the Silver Ridge Gorge and within the National Park boundary. Its spur branches south from the mainline, occupying a flat clearing that provides room for tank car spotting, storage tanks, and truck loading facilities. The depot receives diesel fuel, heating oil, and propane by rail, distributing these supplies by truck to the mine, the railroad itself, and the surrounding communities.

The fuel depot's existence within the park boundary is governed by a modern conditional-use permit, granted on the basis of its essential role in supporting operations that would otherwise require significantly more truck traffic on mountain roads. The permit imposes strict environmental and safety conditions, which the depot's operators take seriously as the foundation of their continued right to operate.

Handling tank cars at the fuel depot requires strict adherence to hazardous materials protocols. Tank cars are never spotted immediately adjacent to a locomotive. Speed restrictions apply on the spur approach. Hand brakes must be applied and wheel chocks set before any car is uncoupled. Crews are trained in spill response procedures, and communication with the depot's ground staff is mandatory during all switching moves. These protocols are not optional — they are conditions of the operating permit and the railroad's own safety standards.

Outbound traffic from the fuel depot consists almost entirely of empty tank cars returning to the interchange at PVJ for reuse. Inbound loads arrive on a schedule tied to seasonal demand, with the heaviest traffic occurring in autumn and early winter as communities and the mine stock up for the cold months ahead.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Timberline Fuel Depot spur and storage area
[SRRX Caption] The fuel depot occupies level ground north of the gorge, receiving tank cars of diesel, heating oil, and propane for regional distribution.

3.4. The Silver Smelter

The Silver Smelter is the oldest industrial operation on the SRRX. When the Silver Ridge Mine was established, the decision was made to process ore on the west side of the mountain, where labor, water from the Silver Ridge River, and transport connections were accessible.

The Silver Ridge Smelter sits on the lower slope of Silver Ridge Mountain, connected to the mine above it by the same branch line. The smelter predates the surrounding Elk River National Park District by decades; its operating rights are grandfathered, and the slag pile that accumulates on the south face of its site remains a point of low-grade negotiation between the railroad and park administration. The smelter does not advertise. It does not need to.

Ore moves from the mine by gravity. Loaded cars descend the switchbacks under control, to the smelter turnout, where the helper engine waiting there joins the consist for the final push up the smelter spur. The grade from the turnout to the smelter is steep enough that neither the road engine nor the helper attempts it alone with a full load. Once spotted at the smelter, cars are unloaded and processed. The engines return light to PVJ. Empty ore cars are collected from the smelter on a separate run and returned to PVJ for storage until needed at the mine.

Like Timberline Lumber, the smelter predates the National Park District and operates under a long-standing BLM lease. Its continued existence within the park boundary is justified by its economic significance to the region and its deep historical roots. The facility is aging, its output modest compared to its peak years, but it remains an active and essential customer. The smelter's stacks, slag pile, and weathered structures give the west wall district a gritty industrial character that contrasts sharply with the natural beauty of the gorge immediately to the south.

3.5. The Silver Ridge Mine

The Silver Ridge Mine is the SRRX's highest, most remote, and most operationally demanding customer. Reached only by the switchback-equipped mine branch departing Pine Valley Junction, the mine sits on a narrow bench carved into the northwest face of Silver Ridge Mountain. It is the economic engine that has driven the railroad since its founding, and the traffic it generates — heavy outbound ore loads and the empties that precede them — shapes the railroad's operating plan more than any other single factor.

The mine loads raw ore into short hopper cars on the loading tracks at the bench. Because the tracks are short and the terrain is constrained, trains must be broken into smaller cuts for efficient positioning under the loader. Mine staff and train crew coordinate closely to manage the loading process, reassemble cuts, and prepare the train for the descent. Every movement on the mine bench requires precision — there is no room for error at this elevation and in this geometry.

The weight difference between inbound empties and outbound loads defines the SRRX's helper strategy. Empty ore cars are light enough to move under road locomotive power alone on the mainline but require helper assistance on the steep grades of the mine branch. The helper and switching locomotive based at PVJ assists empty cuts on the climb, cutting off before the switchback district and returning to yard duties at PVJ. Loaded ore cuts descend under the road locomotive's dynamic braking alone, with strict speed limits maintained throughout the descent.

Weather at mine elevation is severe and unpredictable. Snow can accumulate rapidly, ice forms on the rails with little warning, and high winds funnel through the exposed switchback district with considerable force. Mine operations are suspended during the worst conditions, and the railroad maintains a small snowplow for clearing the branch after heavy falls. Despite these challenges, the mine operates year-round, its steady output providing the revenue backbone that keeps the SRRX viable through every season.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Silver Ridge Mine loading tracks
[SRRX Caption] The mine's narrow bench and short loading tracks require trains to be broken into cuts for positioning. Every movement demands precision at this elevation.

3.6. The Valley Flyer

The Valley Flyer is the SRRX's passenger service, operating between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge with full loop operation during peak season and shorter point-to-point runs in the off-season. While passenger revenue is modest, the Flyer's contribution to the railroad extends far beyond ticket sales. It serves year-round commuters traveling between Silver Ridge and PVJ, winter sport enthusiasts and sightseers who rely on it when mountain roads are difficult, and summer tourists drawn by the dramatic scenery of the gorge and the National Park District.

From a traffic perspective the Valley Flyer generates a small but consistent baggage-express business alongside its passenger load. Park service materials, mail, and local shipments too small or time-sensitive for a freight consist move in the Flyer's baggage car, providing a service to the communities along the line that a freight-only railroad could not offer. This combination of passenger, express, and light freight traffic makes the Flyer operationally versatile and economically more valuable than its modest consist might suggest.

The Valley Flyer's schedule takes precedence over freight movements. Freight crews plan their switching and staging around the Flyer's timetable, clearing into sidings and holding at passing locations as needed. The passing siding at Silver Ridge is the primary meet point on the loop, allowing freight and passenger movements to coordinate without delaying either service unduly.

The Valley Flyer is treated in full — its history, equipment, operating pattern, and cultural significance — in Section 6.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Valley Flyer at Silver Ridge depot

[SRRX Caption] The Valley Flyer serves commuters, tourists, and sightseers year-round, its schedule shaping freight operations across the entire line.

3.7. Seasonal and Special Traffic

Freight traffic on the SRRX varies with the seasons in ways that ripple through the entire operating plan. Timberline Lumber sees its heaviest activity in late spring and summer, when logging conditions are favorable and construction markets are active. The fuel depot's peak demand falls in autumn and early winter, as communities and the mine build fuel stocks before the coldest months. Mine output is relatively steady year-round, though severe winter weather can interrupt loading schedules and reduce train lengths on the branch.

Beyond regular freight, the SRRX handles a range of special movements throughout the year. Work extras support track maintenance, structure repairs, and vegetation control on the right-of-way, often carrying the only practical means of reaching remote sections of the line. Snow service trains run ahead of scheduled movements during and after heavy snowfall, clearing the gorge approaches and the Timberline grade before the Valley Flyer or a mine run proceeds. During fire season, fire patrol trains operate in coordination with the National Park District, carrying water, tools, and personnel through the park corridor.

The National Park District generates occasional special movements of its own: equipment moves for trail maintenance, seasonal staffing shuttles, and supply runs to park facilities accessible only by rail. These movements reinforce the SRRX's relationship with the park and provide operational variety that keeps the railroad's crews engaged through quieter freight periods.

Community specials — holiday excursions, photography charters, and occasional celebration trains — round out the calendar. These events are infrequent but disproportionately valuable for the railroad's public image, drawing attention to the SRRX and the region it serves in ways that routine freight operations never could.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Snow service operations on the Timberline grade
[SRRX Caption] Seasonal traffic patterns and special movements keep the SRRX's operating calendar varied throughout the year.

3.8. Traffic Balance and Operational Impact

The SRRX's traffic mix creates a dynamic and demanding operational environment. The combination of heavy mineral loads, hazardous fuel shipments, time-sensitive passenger service, and the two-stage mine-to-smelter flow requires careful scheduling and precise dispatching. On a single-track mountain railroad with limited passing locations, even minor timing errors can cascade into delays that affect the entire day's operations.

The balance between inbound empties and outbound loads is the central challenge of the daily operating plan. Mine empties must reach PVJ in time to be assembled and dispatched up the branch on schedule. Loaded ore cuts returning from the mine must be forwarded to the smelter without blocking the mainline loop for freight or passenger movements. Fuel tank cars must be handled with the care their hazardous contents demand, regardless of schedule pressure.

Despite its modest scale, the SRRX operates a traffic base of genuine complexity. Every carload contributes to the railroad's survival. Every movement requires skill, planning, and a clear understanding of how each train interacts with every other. This is what mountain railroading demands — and what the SRRX, after a century of practice, has learned to deliver.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Traffic balance diagram
[SRRX Caption] The interplay of mineral loads, fuel traffic, lumber, and passenger service creates a demanding but rewarding operating environment on the SRRX.

SECTION 4 – LOCOMOTIVES AND ROLLING STOCK

4.1. Overview of the Fleet

The Silver Ridge Railway operates a small but carefully considered fleet of locomotives and rolling stock, each unit selected or retained for its ability to handle the specific demands of mountain railroading. Steep grades, tight curves, short sidings, and the precise handling requirements of the switchback district leave no room for equipment that cannot perform reliably under pressure. The SRRX does not operate glamorous locomotives — it operates capable ones.

The fleet divides into three functional groups: road locomotives that handle mainline freight and passenger service, the helper and switching locomotive based at Pine Valley Junction, and the rolling stock fleet that serves the railroad's four freight customers and the Valley Flyer. Maintenance of way equipment rounds out the roster, providing the tools needed to keep the right-of-way in serviceable condition through every season.

The SRRX acquires equipment the way a shortline always has — opportunistically, on a limited budget, from whatever sources are available. Road units are typically secondhand acquisitions from larger carriers, chosen for mechanical soundness and compatibility with the railroad's maintenance capabilities rather than age or appearance. The result is a roster with character: no two locomotives are quite alike, and each carries the history of its previous service alongside the SRRX's own paint and road numbers.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — SRRX locomotive roster overview
[SRRX Caption] The SRRX fleet is small, practical, and chosen for reliability on steep grades and tight curves.

4.2. Road Locomotives

The SRRX's road locomotives handle mainline freight movements, mine branch ore runs, and Valley Flyer passenger service. These units must balance tractive effort on the grades with the agility needed to navigate tight curves and short industrial spurs. Road-switcher types have historically served the railroad well, offering the flexibility to handle both line haul and switching duties as traffic demands.

The road fleet is maintained at the Pine Valley Engine House, where crews perform routine inspections, minor repairs, and seasonal adjustments. Major overhauls are coordinated with outside shops accessible via the Class I interchange at PVJ, typically scheduled during slower traffic periods to minimize operational impact.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — SRRX road locomotive at Pine Valley Junction
[SRRX Caption] Road locomotives handle mainline freight, ore runs, and Valley Flyer service across the full operating territory.

4.3. The Helper and Switching Locomotive

The helper and switching locomotive is the most consistently active unit on the SRRX. Based permanently at Pine Valley Junction, it earns its keep in two distinct roles that between them account for a significant portion of the railroad's daily operational activity.

As the yard switcher, it builds and breaks trains at PVJ, spots cars for the interchange, handles inbound empties from the Class I connection, and positions cuts for departure on both the mainline and the mine branch. The yard at PVJ is compact but operationally complex, and the switcher's ability to handle short, precise movements in confined spaces is essential to keeping trains moving on schedule.

As the mine branch helper, the same locomotive assists empty ore cuts on the steep climb from PVJ to the switchback district. The grade demands more tractive effort than the road locomotive alone can reliably provide on a full cut of empties, and the helper's contribution on the climb is the difference between a

controlled ascent and a stalled train on a steep mountain grade. Once the empty cut clears the lower portion of the branch and the helper's work is done, it cuts off and returns to PVJ for yard duties, leaving the road locomotive to continue alone to the mine.

This dual role is not a compromise — it is a deliberate operational philosophy. A railroad of the SRRX's size cannot justify a dedicated helper sitting idle between mine runs. By designing the helper district to begin at PVJ rather than at an intermediate point on the branch, the railroad ensures that its second locomotive is productive throughout the operating day rather than waiting at a remote location for its next assignment.

Light, nimble switcher types are best suited to this dual role. A unit that can thread through the PVJ yard with precision can also handle the early portion of the mine branch climb without difficulty. The SRRX has historically favored GE switcher types for this assignment, their reliability and relatively simple maintenance requirements making them well suited to a railroad where every locomotive must earn its place.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Helper locomotive at Pine Valley Junction
[SRRX Caption] The helper and switching locomotive pulls double duty at PVJ — yard switcher by day, mine branch helper when ore runs are scheduled.

4.4. Passenger Power and the Valley Flyer

The Valley Flyer does not require dedicated passenger power. On the SRRX, the available road locomotive typically handles the Flyer's lightweight consist alongside or instead of freight duties, depending on the day's operating plan. This arrangement is consistent with the railroad's practical philosophy and reflects the reality of shortline passenger operations in the late twentieth century: dedicated passenger locomotives are a luxury a railroad of this size cannot justify.

In practice, whichever road unit is available and properly serviced handles the Flyer. The locomotive's dynamic braking capability is important for controlled descents on the grades, and its low-speed performance must be smooth enough to provide a comfortable ride for passengers through the gorge and on the mountain approaches. Decoder speed matching and momentum settings are therefore more critical for Flyer service than for freight work, where a slightly abrupt throttle response is an inconvenience rather than a passenger comfort issue.

The possibility of assigning a visually distinctive unit to the Flyer on a regular basis — giving the passenger service a consistent identity in the eyes of the public and the railfan community — is worth considering as the roster develops. A locomotive maintained in cleaner condition and assigned a passenger-oriented paint scheme or number would reinforce the Valley Flyer's role as the railroad's public face without requiring a dedicated unit that sits idle when the Flyer is not running.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Valley Flyer power on the gorge approach
[SRRX Caption] The Valley Flyer is typically handled by whichever road locomotive is available, with smooth low-speed performance a priority for passenger comfort on the grades.

4.5. Maintenance of Way Equipment

The SRRX maintains a small but essential inventory of maintenance of way equipment to support track, structure, and right-of-way work across its operating territory. Because road access to much of the line is limited or nonexistent — particularly in the gorge, on the Timberline grade, and on the mine branch — rail is often the only practical means of moving tools, materials, and personnel to work sites.

The railroad's MOW fleet includes a small snowplow for clearing the mine branch and the gorge approaches after heavy snowfall, a gondola or work flat for transporting materials, and a tool car for crew equipment and supplies. These units are stored at PVJ between assignments and operated as work extras under the road or switching locomotive as conditions require.

Winter MOW operations are among the most demanding on the railroad. The snowplow must clear the mine branch before ore runs can proceed after heavy falls, and the gorge approach requires attention before the Valley Flyer can operate safely. Snow service trains run ahead of scheduled movements during active weather, with crews monitoring conditions and clearing problem areas as needed. Road salt storage domes at PVJ support turnout and grade crossing maintenance during icy conditions.

The fire tower on the upper slopes of Silver Ridge Mountain, maintained in cooperation with the National Park District, provides early warning of fire conditions in the park corridor. During fire season, the SRRX positions a water tank car and tool flat at PVJ for rapid deployment as a fire patrol train if conditions require. This arrangement reflects the railroad's role as a partner in regional land management, not merely a freight carrier.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — MOW equipment at Pine Valley Junction
[SRRX Caption] The SRRX's MOW fleet supports track and structure maintenance across territory where road access is limited or impossible.

4.6. Freight Rolling Stock

The SRRX's freight car fleet reflects the specific needs of its four customers. Cars are selected for their ability to handle the railroad's tight curves, steep grades, and limited track space at the industries. Every car in regular service must meet NMRA wheel gauge standards, carry adequate weight for stable operation on the grades, and have couplers that operate reliably through the switchback district's complex movements.

Ore hoppers serve the Silver Ridge Mine, carrying raw ore down from the mine bench to PVJ and onward to the smelter. These cars are short and rugged, sized to fit the mine's constrained loading tracks and to negotiate the tight curves of the switchback district. Loaded ore hoppers are among the heaviest cars on the railroad, and their descent from the mine requires careful dynamic braking and strict adherence to speed limits.

Tank cars serve the Timberline Fuel Depot, arriving loaded with diesel fuel, heating oil, and propane and departing as empties. These cars require the most careful handling on the railroad due to their hazardous contents, and are never mixed into a consist in positions that place them adjacent to the locomotive. The fuel depot's level spur simplifies car handling compared to the graded spurs elsewhere on the line, but hazmat protocols apply regardless of grade or conditions.

Centerbeam flats and boxcars serve Timberline Lumber, carrying finished dimensional lumber and rough-cut timber outbound to the interchange. Centerbeams are preferred for dimensional lumber due to their load restraint characteristics; boxcars handle weather-sensitive products. These cars are spotted in small cuts on the graded Timberline spur, requiring careful brake management during switching.

General freight — boxcars, flats, and occasional specialty equipment — serves the PVJ team track and handles inbound supplies for the communities and industries along the line. Reefers appear occasionally as interchange traffic passing through rather than as local customers, reflecting the SRRX's role as a bridge between its industries and the national rail network.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — SRRX freight car types
[SRRX Caption] The freight fleet is matched to the specific needs of each customer, with car type, weight, and coupler condition critical for reliable operation on the grades.

4.7. Passenger Equipment

The Valley Flyer operates with a lightweight consist designed for short-distance scenic service on steep, winding mountain railroad. The consist is intentionally modest — a small railroad serving a small community does not need or operate large passenger trains — but it is maintained to a higher standard of appearance than the freight fleet, reflecting the Flyer's role as the railroad's most visible public operation.

The core consist includes two passenger coaches providing seating for tourists, commuters, and sightseers, and a combination baggage-express car that handles mail, park service materials, and small local shipments alongside passenger luggage. An observation car at the end of the Flyer adds visual character appropriate to the railroad's era and provides an observation platform for passengers who want an unobstructed rear view of the scenery.

The passenger cars are stored and serviced at Pine Valley Junction between runs. Their electrical pickups, truck condition, and coupler alignment receive particular attention during maintenance checks, as smooth operation through the gorge curves and on the mountain approaches is essential for passenger comfort. Any car that does not roll freely or that exhibits coupler binding is removed from Flyer service until corrected.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Valley Flyer consist at Silver Ridge depot

[SRRX Caption] The Valley Flyer's modest consist is maintained to a higher standard of appearance than the freight fleet, reflecting its role as the railroad's public face.

4.8. Fleet Philosophy and Acquisition

The SRRX acquires and retains equipment according to a simple principle: if it can do useful work reliably on this railroad, it earns its place on the roster. If it cannot — whether due to mechanical condition, incompatible couplers, or curves and grades it cannot negotiate — it is a parts source or a display piece, not an operational asset.

Coupler standardization is the single most important factor in fleet reliability on a railroad with the SRRX's operational complexity. Mismatched couplers cause more operational disruptions than any other equipment issue, particularly in the switchback district where precise coupling and uncoupling under load is required. The railroad's long-term goal is full standardization across the operational fleet, with conversions prioritized by operational importance: locomotives first, then cars in regular mine branch and Timberline service, then general freight.

DCC decoder installation and speed matching across the locomotive fleet is the second priority. Helper operations require the road locomotive and the helper to run as a consist with matched speed characteristics across the full throttle range. A helper that surges or lags relative to the road unit creates buff and draft forces that stress both locomotives and the cars between them — a particular concern on the mine branch where the grades amplify any handling irregularities.

The fleet will grow and evolve as the railroad develops. Acquisitions will be evaluated against the railroad's specific operational needs — the mine branch grade, the switchback geometry, the Timberline spur — rather than general desirability. On the SRRX, a reliable secondhand GE switcher is worth more than a beautiful locomotive that cannot handle the mountain.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Pine Valley Engine House

[SRRX Caption] The Pine Valley Engine House is the maintenance hub for the SRRX fleet, where reliability is valued above all else.

SECTION 5 – COMMUNITIES AND PEOPLE

5.1. Overview — Two Towns, One Railroad

The Silver Ridge Railway connects two communities that could hardly be more different in character, yet neither could exist without the other. Pine Valley Junction is a railroad town — utilitarian, purposeful, shaped entirely by the yard and the industries it serves. Silver Ridge is a mountain community — more open, more varied, its identity drawn from the landscape as much as from the railroad. Together they form the human heart of the SRRX's territory, and the railroad that runs between them is as much a social connector as an economic one.

The relationship between the two towns is one of quiet interdependence. PVJ provides the operational muscle — the crews, the yard, the interchange connection that gives both communities access to the outside world. Silver Ridge provides the population base, the tourism draw, and the political visibility that keeps the railroad relevant in an era when shortlines across the country have struggled to survive. Neither town would be what it is without the railroad. And the railroad would not be what it is without both towns.

Between them lies the National Park District, a protected corridor that shapes the character of everything it touches. The park is not a community in the conventional sense, but it has a human presence — rangers, seasonal workers, trail crews, and the steady flow of visitors that the Valley Flyer brings through the gorge and across the mountain slopes each summer. The park's relationship with the SRRX is one of the railroad's most important and most carefully maintained partnerships.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — The two communities and the railroad that connects them

[SRRX Caption] Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge are connected by the SRRX and shaped by it — two towns with different characters but a shared dependence on the mountain railroad.

5.2. Pine Valley Junction — The Railroad Town

Pine Valley Junction did not grow around a church or a courthouse or a trading post. It grew around a yard. The first permanent structures here were railroad buildings — a small depot, a section house, a water facility — and the town that followed was built to serve the people who worked them. Everything about PVJ reflects this origin: the streets run parallel to the tracks, the houses are close together and practically built, and the pace of life is set by the rhythm of the operating day rather than the calendar.

The yard is the town's reason for existing and its largest employer. Yard crews, engine house staff, dispatchers, and track maintenance workers make up the core of PVJ's population. Most walk to work. The Pine Valley Engine House anchors the east end of the yard, its service tracks and inspection pits the center of mechanical life on the railroad. The yard office sits at the throat of the yard, close enough to the action that a dispatcher can hear a locomotive idling from his desk.

The town itself is compact. A short commercial street runs parallel to the tracks — a diner that opens before dawn for early crews, a hardware and supply store, a small post office, a bar that does its best business on Friday evenings when the week's runs are done. Housing is modest and well-maintained, the homes of people who work with their hands and take quiet pride in keeping things in order. There are no tourist shops in PVJ, no scenic overlooks, no interpretive signs. The town has no particular interest in being discovered.

The Class I interchange at the west end of the yard is PVJ's connection to the national economy. Inbound cars arrive here from the broader rail network, and outbound loads depart for markets that the SRRX's own line could never reach. The interchange is a modest facility by Class I standards — a run-around track, a few staging tracks, a simple handoff protocol — but it is the reason PVJ exists where it does and the economic foundation on which the entire railroad rests.

PVJ is not a pretty town, but it is an honest one. It knows what it is, it does what it does, and it has been doing it for long enough that the mountain itself seems to have accepted the arrangement.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Pine Valley Junction town and yard
[SRRX Caption] PVJ is a railroad town in the truest sense — built around the yard, shaped by the operating day, and quietly proud of both.

5.3. Silver Ridge — The Mountain Community

Silver Ridge is the kind of town that people come to on purpose. It sits on the valley floor at the south end of the SRRX's territory, open to the sky in a way that the gorge and the upper districts are not, with the Silver Ridge River nearby and the mountain rising to the north as a constant backdrop. The town has room to breathe — a main street with genuine commerce, a park with mature trees, neighborhoods that spread out toward the trailheads and the river.

Where PVJ is defined by what it does, Silver Ridge is defined by where it is. The mountain, the park, the river, and the railroad all converge here, and the town has grown into that convergence over several generations. Mining families put down roots here when the smelter was young. Timber workers followed when Timberline Lumber established its operation. Park service personnel began arriving when the National Park District was designated, and tourism followed the park. The result is a community with more layers than its size might suggest — old mining money, working families, seasonal workers, and a steady stream of visitors who sometimes stay.

The SRRX depot at Silver Ridge is the most public-facing facility on the railroad. It serves the Valley Flyer and handles the baggage-express traffic that moves with it, but it also functions as an informal information center for visitors arriving to explore the park and the gorge. A bulletin board inside the depot carries train schedules, park trail conditions, and the kind of handwritten notices that accumulate in any small-town public space. The depot agent, if the position is staffed, knows everyone in town by name.

Most of the SRRX's non-yard workforce lives in Silver Ridge. Engineers and conductors who work the mainline runs commute to PVJ by train or vehicle at the start of their shifts and return home to Silver Ridge at the end. Some take the Valley Flyer. Others drive the mountain road that parallels the line on the east side of the valley. A few have lived in the same house their whole careers, watching the railroad from the same window every morning before heading to work.

Silver Ridge also serves as the primary point of contact between the railroad and the outside world. Tourists arrive here, railfans set up on the platform to photograph the Flyer, and local officials meet with railroad representatives in the conference room above the depot. The town's relationship with the SRRX is warmer and more visible than PVJ's — less about operational necessity and more about shared identity and regional pride.

The commercial heart of Silver Ridge runs along a main street that is practical before it is picturesque. The Dew Drop Inn anchors the block — a diner and bar that opens early enough for the first crew shift and stays open late enough for the last train home. Counter seating, a short menu, coffee always on. It is the kind of place where a conductor can get a meal between runs without ceremony, and where a hiker arriving on the Valley Flyer can get trail conditions from someone who was actually up there yesterday. A general store adjacent to it stocks what a working community needs alongside what a weekend camper forgot. An outfitter handles the gear, the rentals, and the kind of advice you can only get from someone who knows the mountain. A gas station occupies the corner where the highway curves toward the trailhead parking.

The civic block runs a short distance off main street: a post office where most residents have a mailbox, a combined fire and police station that staffs a single shift without much idle time, a town hall that doubles as a community meeting room, and the Yampa Valley Bank, which has held the same corner long enough that regulars refer to it by a name that hasn't been on the sign in a generation. The brewery sits at the edge

of the commercial district — a working operation that sells locally and ships modestly, one of the town's more recent enterprises and one of its more successful ones. Above the main street, on a bench of ground that keeps it slightly apart from the commerce below, a nondescript federal building houses whatever offices have claimed the space over the decades. The building does not attract attention, which appears to be the point.

The residential streets behind the main block reflect Silver Ridge's layered history. Older mining-era homes sit close to the street. Timber-frame construction from the mid-century fills the middle blocks. Three Sears catalog homes on one street — built from the same plans but painted differently enough over the years that only someone looking deliberately would place them — represent the peculiar combination of railroad logistics and mail-order commerce that shaped mountain towns throughout the region. Newer construction occupies the edge of town where the trailheads begin, built for a population that arrived with the park economy and stayed.

[DETAIL: Confirm the layout of the Silver Ridge town area — park location, main street orientation, depot position relative to the passing siding, any other scenic or operational details.]

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Silver Ridge depot and town
[SRRX Caption] Silver Ridge is the SRRX's most public-facing community — the place where the railroad meets its passengers, its visitors, and its broader identity as a regional institution.

5.4. The National Park District — Stewards and Visitors

The National Park District is not a town, but it is not empty either. Rangers live and work in the park year-round, maintaining trails, monitoring wildlife, managing the visitor experience, and keeping a watchful eye on the industrial operations that predate the park's designation. Seasonal workers arrive each spring to staff trailheads, run interpretive programs, and support the surge of summer visitors. Trail crews spend weeks at a time in the backcountry, accessible in the more remote sections only by rail.

The park's relationship with the SRRX is one of the most important partnerships either institution maintains. For the railroad, the park provides political legitimacy, a captive passenger market via the Valley Flyer, and the goodwill of a federal agency that could make right-of-way renewal difficult if relations were poor. For the park, the railroad provides controlled visitor access to terrain that would otherwise require significant road construction, a means of moving equipment and personnel to remote work sites, and a visible symbol of the region's layered history.

The park's ranger station sits within the protected corridor, visible from the mainline and accessible by trail from the gorge overlook. At the north approach to the gorge, the park boundary is marked by a stone-base entry sign visible from the Valley Flyer's consist — the transition point where passengers who know what they are looking for begin to look for it. A short stub siding at the gorge approach serves the Gorge Flagstop, a scheduled stop on the Valley Flyer's summer full-loop service. The Gorge-ous Grub — a former SRRX caboose repainted in maroon and cream and retired to the stub track — provides a counter, a short menu, and a reason to step off the train for twenty minutes and stand at the edge of the gorge before the consist departs without you. Picnic tables occupy the clearing between the siding and the rim. The caboose has not moved under its own power in some time. There is no indication it intends to. A small maintenance facility nearby stores trail equipment and seasonal supplies, some of which arrive by rail in the Flyer's baggage car. The fire tower on the upper slopes of Silver Ridge Mountain is a park facility, staffed during fire season and visible from much of the railroad's operating territory as a reminder of the environment in which the SRRX operates.

Visitors arrive in the park primarily via Silver Ridge and the Valley Flyer. In summer the Flyer carries hikers, photographers, and families to the gorge overlook and the park's lower trailheads. In winter a smaller but dedicated group of cross-country skiers, snowshoers, and winter photographers makes the same journey,

drawn by the park's stark beauty and the relative solitude of the off-season. The railroad accommodates both, adjusting its consist and schedule to match the season's demands.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — National Park District ranger station and gorge overlook
[SRRX Caption] The park's human presence — rangers, seasonal workers, and visitors — makes it a living part of the SRRX's operating territory rather than simply a scenic backdrop.

5.5. The People of the SRRX

A railroad this size runs on a small number of people who know each other well. The SRRX's operating crew is compact enough that everyone who works the line knows everyone else — not just by name but by habit, by strength, by the particular way they handle a locomotive on a wet grade or work a switchback in the dark. This familiarity is one of the railroad's operational assets. It is also, on bad days, one of its complications.

The locomotive crews — engineers and conductors — are the most visible faces of the railroad. They handle the daily freight runs, work the mine branch, and operate the Valley Flyer with the same quiet professionalism regardless of whether the consist carries ore or passengers. Most have worked the line long enough to know every curve and every grade crossing by feel, and they carry that knowledge in the way experienced mountain railroaders always do — not as a point of pride but as a simple operational fact.

The yard crew at PVJ handles the less visible but equally essential work of building trains, spotting cars, and managing the interchange. Their work is measured in precision — a car spotted two feet out of position at Timberline Lumber is a car that can't be loaded efficiently, and a train built in the wrong order at PVJ is a train that has to be reshuffled at the worst possible moment. The yard crew's competence is the foundation on which the rest of the operating day is built.

The engine house staff keep the locomotives running. On a railroad with a fleet this small, there is no margin for equipment downtime. A locomotive out of service is not an inconvenience — it is an operational crisis. The maintenance staff's ability to diagnose problems quickly, improvise solutions with limited parts inventory, and return units to service in minimum time is as important to the railroad's survival as anything the operating crews do on the line.

The dispatcher — a single position on a railroad this size — coordinates all of it. Freight movements, Valley Flyer schedule adherence, helper assignments, work extra placements, and the constant negotiation between what the operating plan calls for and what the mountain allows. It is not a glamorous job. It is an essential one.

Beyond the operating staff, the SRRX is sustained by the communities it serves. The families of crew members, the businesses that depend on rail access, the tourists who ride the Valley Flyer and spend money in Silver Ridge, the park rangers who rely on the railroad to do their jobs — all of them are part of the railroad's story, even if their names never appear on a waybill or a train order.

[DETAIL: Consider naming one or two key characters for operations scenarios — a veteran engineer, a long-serving dispatcher, a young hire learning the mine branch. Named characters make operating sessions more engaging and give the railroad a human face beyond the equipment roster.]

[SRRX Figure] Figure — SRRX crew at Pine Valley Junction
[SRRX Caption] The SRRX runs on a small number of people who know the railroad and each other well — a compact crew whose skill and familiarity with the mountain is the railroad's most important operational asset.

5.6. Community and Railroad — An Interdependence

The SRRX and the communities it serves have been shaping each other for long enough that it is no longer possible to say which came first. The railroad needed the mine, and the mine needed the railroad. The smelter needed the tunnel, and the tunnel created the loop that made the whole operation viable. PVJ grew

because the yard was there. Silver Ridge grew because the valley was accessible and the railroad made it more so.

This interdependence is the railroad's greatest strength and its most significant vulnerability. As long as the mine produces, the smelter processes, and the timber moves, the SRRX is viable. If any one of those industries falters, the balance shifts. The railroad has navigated these shifts before — it has outlasted boom-and-bust cycles, survived the closure of industries it once depended on, and reinvented itself more than once to remain relevant. The Valley Flyer is the most recent reinvention, and perhaps the most durable: as long as people want to see the gorge from a moving train, there will be a reason for the SRRX to exist.

The communities understand this. Silver Ridge residents know that their town's character — its tourism economy, its accessibility, its identity as a gateway to the park — depends on a railroad that most of them use only occasionally. PVJ residents know it more viscerally: the yard is their livelihood, and the yard exists because the industries along the line keep it busy. Both towns have a stake in the railroad's survival that goes beyond convenience or sentiment.

That shared stake is what keeps the SRRX running when the economics alone might not justify it. It is what fills the seats on the Valley Flyer when the weather is poor and the tourists have stayed home. It is what brings the town council to the table when the railroad needs right-of-way support or a quiet word with the park service. The SRRX endures not because it is profitable in every quarter or efficient by any modern measure, but because the people and communities along its line have decided, generation after generation, that they are better off with it than without it.

[SRRX Figure] Figure — Valley Flyer departing Silver Ridge
[SRRX Caption] The SRRX endures because the communities along its line have decided, generation after generation, that they are better off with it than without it.

SECTION 6 – The Valley Flyer

6.1. Origins of the Service

The Valley Flyer did not begin as a passenger railroad. The Silver Ridge Railway was built for ore — to move raw mineral from the mine on the northwest face of Silver Ridge Mountain down to the smelter on the west wall, and to deliver the refined product to the interchange at Pine Valley Junction for forwarding to the broader network. Passengers, in those early years, were an afterthought at best.

What changed the equation was geography. The route the railroad had carved to serve its industrial customers happened to traverse some of the most dramatic mountain scenery in the region. The Silver Ridge Gorge, the river valley, the long views across the national park district — these were not engineered for effect. They were simply the terrain the railroad had to cross to reach its freight customers. But the scenery was undeniable, and word got out.

The first scheduled passenger movements were informal by any measure — a coach attached to a freight consist on an irregular basis, accommodating mine and smelter workers commuting between Pine Valley Junction and the town of Silver Ridge. There was no timetable, no depot service to speak of, and no pretense of a passenger railroad. But the arrangement persisted, and demand quietly grew.

As the national park district developed and tourism to the region increased, the railroad found itself fielding requests for dedicated excursion service. A summer season trial — a proper consist with assigned equipment, a published schedule, and a name — proved more successful than management had expected. The Valley Flyer was born.

Over successive seasons the service matured from a summer curiosity into a genuine year-round operation. Workers from Pine Valley Junction moved to Silver Ridge and used the railroad to commute. Winter sport visitors arriving at the valley in ski season, and a steady stream of summer tourists and park visitors all found the railroad useful. The Flyer became something the SRRX had not initially planned to be: the public face of the railroad, and a source of goodwill that freight revenue alone could never have purchased.

[SRRX Figure: Valley Flyer at Silver Ridge depot — summer season]
[SRRX Caption: The Valley Flyer at the Silver Ridge depot. Summer consists include two coaches and the baggage-express car.]

6.2. The Route

The Valley Flyer operates over the SRRX mainline between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge. In summer peak season, the train runs the full loop — departing PVJ westbound, stopping at the PVJ depot for passengers, entering the tunnels and descending the west wall past the gorge, calling at Silver Ridge, and returning eastbound through the national park district along the river, and back to PVJ. Off-season, the service typically runs as a point-to-point movement, PVJ to Silver Ridge and return, skipping the full loop circuit.

Pine Valley Junction (PVJ) is the originating terminal. The Flyer departs from the Pine Valley Yard throat, using the mainline lead. The dedicated passenger facility at PVJ is separate from the yard operations; the depot shares the spur on the south side of PVJ with the intermodal team track. Consists are assembled and spotted on the main before departure. Ticketing and baggage handling are conducted from the depot building.

Departing the PVJ depot, the mainline heads west, back past the yard through the Pine Valley District and heads into the outer tunnel, then south along the east leg. This stretch passes through the lower reaches of the national park, with the Silver Ridge River visible to the west and the mountain slopes rising to the east. The Timberline District occupies the middle portion of the east run; passengers on the right side of

the train may observe the Timberline Lumber facility above the mainline on a climbing spur, though the working mill is not a formal stop.

The mainline continues south into the Silver Ridge District at the south end of the east leg. The track curves into the town loop here, passing the park and the main street before reaching the Silver Ridge depot. This is the primary intermediate passenger stop on the line. In summer full-loop operation, the Valley Flyer also makes a flagstop at the Gorge Flagstop on the west wall approach — a seasonal stop at the gorge overlook where leisure passengers may detrain and reboard a later consist. The flagstop operates on summer full-loop schedule only; point-to-point off-season service does not include it. The town is the largest community on the railroad and the primary destination for leisure travelers and commuters alike.

In summer loop operation, the Flyer departs Silver Ridge westbound and immediately enters the Gorge and West Wall District. The Silver Ridge Gorge crossing is the most dramatic segment of the entire route — a high bridge over the river canyon with open views in both directions. The gorge is the feature most cited by returning visitors as the reason they came back. North of the gorge, the mainline climbs slightly along the west wall past the Silver Smelter and the Timberline Fuel Depot before entering the inner tunnel, approaching Pine Valley District from the east and completing the loop at PVJ depot.

[SRRX Figure: Valley Flyer crossing the Silver Ridge Gorge bridge]
[SRRX Caption: The gorge crossing is the signature moment of the full loop. The bridge is visible from both approaches.]

6.3. Equipment and Consist

The Valley Flyer operate with a consist assembled from the SRRX's available passenger and express equipment. The railroad does not maintain dedicated passenger-only power; the road locomotive handles Flyer duties alongside its freight assignments, rostered to the consist at the start of each operating session.

The standard summer consist is: road locomotive — observation car — coach.

It completes the traditional mountain railroad silhouette and functions as overflow space for peak-season loadings. Off-season consists are typically reduced to a single coach and the baggage-express car.

Baggage-express car: There is no dedicated baggage-express car. The passenger coach fills that duty, with the rear portion dedicated to this purpose. This is the workhorse of the Flyer beyond passenger revenue. Carries USPS mail contract shipments, national park service materials and equipment, small local freight consignments, and seasonal supplies for the Silver Ridge community. The express car revenue is a meaningful contributor to the Flyer's operating economics. It also provides operational justification for year-round service independent of passenger demand alone.

Locomotive assignment: The road unit handles Flyer power. [PENDING: Confirm primary road locomotive — GP30 or B23-7 per Section 4 roster completion]. An F7 or F9 unit in the fleet is a candidate for dedicated Valley Flyer power once decoder conversion is assessed; the white gear risk on that unit has been noted and an extended run test is recommended before committing it to timed passenger service. Until that assessment is complete, the road unit remains the Flyer locomotive of record.

Passenger equipment: There are two passenger cars, a coach and an observation car. These are sufficient to handle the tourist, commuter and express baggage needs of the railroad.

6.4. Operating Pattern and Scheduling

The Valley Flyer operates on a published timetable with priority over freight movements. This priority is not merely a courtesy — it is formal operating policy. Any freight movement that cannot be cleared from the mainline ahead of a scheduled Flyer departure is held until the passenger train has passed. The Flyer does not wait for freight.

Summer peak season (full loop): The Flyer operates the complete mainline circuit — PVJ to Silver Ridge via the east River Run, then Silver Ridge to PVJ via the gorge and west wall, the Scenic Run. Round-trip loop operation. The gorge segment is the primary draw for leisure passengers, and the full loop is marketed as the scenic experience. Consists are at maximum length. The summer full-loop schedule includes a flagstop at the Gorge Flagstop on the west wall approach. The stop is brief — typically fifteen to twenty minutes — and passengers who detrain may reboard the next available consist. The Gorge-ous Grub operates during flagstop hours on a seasonal schedule. The flagstop is not served on off-season or winter point-to-point operations.

Off-season (point-to-point): The Flyer operates PVJ to Silver Ridge and return on the east run only. The gorge segment is skipped. This is the workaday version of the service — commuter-focused, shorter consists, tighter schedule. Year-round ridership is sustained primarily by the commuter base: Silver Ridge residents working in Pine Valley Junction who rely on the train as their primary transportation link into the valley.

Winter sport season: An uptick in ridership occurs during winter months when the mountain attracts snow sport visitors. The Flyer's point-to-point schedule accommodates these passengers without requiring full loop operation — Silver Ridge is the destination, and the east run is the direct route.

Meets and passing: The Silver Ridge passing siding is the primary designated meet point on the loop. When the Flyer is operating full loop, the meet between a westbound and eastbound movement — whether Flyer-to-Flyer on a two-train schedule or Flyer-to-freight — is planned for the Silver Ridge siding. The dispatcher holds all freight clear of the siding when a Flyer arrival is imminent.

The Flyer's schedule is posted in both depot buildings and is the master reference for all operating sessions that include passenger service. Freight crews are responsible for knowing the Flyer's departure times from PVJ and Silver Ridge and planning their movements accordingly.

6.5. The Passenger Experience

For a visitor boarding the Valley Flyer for the first time, the journey is something the SRRX's freight-focused history could not have predicted it would become. The train threads through a landscape that genuinely earns the attention.

Departing Pine Valley Junction depot, the consist heads west, looping back around to the east passing the yard and immediately dives into the tunnel and begins the long southbound ascent along the east leg. The river appears and disappears alongside the track as the valley widens. In summer, the ridge line above Timberline Lumber is green with timber; in autumn, the larches and aspens give the slopes a brief gold that hikers come specifically to see.

The approach to Silver Ridge from the north is gradual — the town resolves slowly from scattered structures into a proper main street with the park at its center. The depot marks the southern limit of town, and the Flyer's arrival is something of an event for a community that does not have many. A few minutes at the platform, the express car doors open and close, and the consist departs again.

For summer passengers continuing the full loop, the departure from Silver Ridge westbound is the beginning of the journey's best act. A mile or so north of Silver Ridge, the train slows on the west wall approach and stops at the Gorge Flagstop — a short siding with a converted caboose and a clutch of picnic tables between the track and the gorge rim. Passengers who have been told about the stop by someone who has made the trip before know to step off here. Those who have not discovered the Gorge-ous Grub are welcome to stay on the consist and regret it later. The stop is fifteen or twenty minutes. The view from the tables is the gorge at its most accessible — standing height, clear sightlines, the river far below. The gorge arrives without much warning — the track curves, the valley drops away, and suddenly the train is on the bridge

with nothing but air and river canyon in both directions. The crossing takes perhaps thirty seconds at normal speed. It is, by some distance, the most photographed location on the railroad.

North of the gorge, the west wall run is industrial in character — the smelter and fuel depot are working facilities, not scenic attractions — but the mountain backdrop remains. The loop closes back into PVJ at the depot with the yard spread across the river, the engine house visible on approach, and the familiar smell of a working railroad yard at the end of the line.

[SRRX Figure: Interior view — Valley Flyer coach, summer consist]
[SRRX Caption: Coach interior, summer season. The baggage-express car handles mail contracts and park service shipments year-round.]

6.6. Significance to the Railroad

The Valley Flyer is the Silver Ridge Railway's most visible product. Every freight car moved on this railroad is invisible to the public; the Flyer is not. It carries names on its sides, a published schedule, and passengers who remember their experiences and talk about them. In a region where a small railroad's continued existence depends in part on the goodwill of regulators, park service partners, and local communities, that visibility has value that does not appear on a freight waybill.

The passenger service also provides a practical political function. The SRRX's freight customers — the mine, the smelter, the fuel depot, the lumber operation — are extractive or industrial in character, and none of them individually generates the kind of community sympathy that sustains a shortline railroad through difficult periods. The Flyer does. When renewal of the BLM operating leases comes up for discussion, or when the railroad needs goodwill at the county level, the Valley Flyer's existence and its role as a regional transportation link is the argument that resonates with audiences that do not care about ore tonnage.

The express car's mail and park service contract also anchors the Flyer to an operational necessity that seasonal tourism alone cannot. A railroad that carries the mail has a different standing than one that merely offers scenic excursions. The SRRX has understood this, and this service has never been dropped from the consist.

The Flyer is, in the end, the version of the Silver Ridge Railway that most people know. The ore trains and the switch jobs and the interchange cuts are the railroad's economic engine. The Valley Flyer is its face.

Pending items in this section:

- Section 6.3: Primary road locomotive identity (GP30 or B23-7) — pending JMRI roster completion
- Section 6.3: Passenger coach quantity, type, and road numbers — pending JMRI roster completion
- Section 6.3: F7/F9 decoder conversion assessment — white gear risk; extended run test recommended before Flyer assignment
- Figures: Valley Flyer at Silver Ridge depot; gorge bridge crossing; coach interior

SECTION 7 – Operating Rules & Procedures

7.1. General Operating Philosophy

The Silver Ridge Railway operates as a common carrier serving the communities and industries of the Silver Ridge valley. It is a working railroad — not a showcase — and every movement on the property reflects that purpose. Trains run on time, cars move to revenue, and the railroad earns its place in the valley.

- The Silver Ridge Railway shall be operated as a prototype shortline railroad of the diesel era, 1970s through 2000s. All operations, equipment assignments, and crew conduct shall reflect practices appropriate to that era and territory.
- The railroad exists to serve its customers. Every operating session shall include at least one revenue movement — a mine run, a manifest freight, a local switching assignment, or the Valley Flyer passenger service.
- Realistic operation is the standard. Deliberate, purposeful movements are preferred over speed. Cars shall be spotted, pulled, and classified as they would be on a working shortline — not simply cycled around the loop.
- The Valley Flyer operates on a fixed priority. Freight movements shall yield to scheduled Valley Flyer operations. See Rule 7.6 for full priority statement.
- Operators are responsible for the equipment assigned to them. Locomotives and cars shall be handled with care appropriate to N scale mechanisms. No equipment shall be forced through a turnout, over a grade, or into a clearance point without first confirming the path is set and clear.
- If a derailment occurs, operations shall pause. The cause shall be identified before resuming. Persistent derailments at a specific location shall be noted for track maintenance.

7.2. Timetable & Train Orders

The Silver Ridge Railway operates under a simplified timetable authority appropriate to a single-track shortline. Pine Valley Junction serves as the controlling agency for all train movements. In the absence of a dispatcher, the timetable governs.

- The SRRX timetable establishes the scheduled times and priority of regular trains. The Valley Flyer holds first-class timetable authority on all mainline segments.
- Unscheduled freight movements — mine runs, local freights, helper assignments — operate as extras. Extras have no timetable authority and shall not occupy the mainline when a scheduled train is due.
- Pine Valley Junction is the point of origin for all outbound movements. Trains departing PVJ shall have all cars classified, all switches properly set, and the departure track clear before movement begins.
- Train orders may be issued to authorize extra movements, modify scheduled times, or impose speed restrictions. During single-operator sessions, the operator functions as both dispatcher and crew. Train order discipline shall still be observed — a written or spoken order clears a movement; assumption does not.
- A train shall not leave a terminal or passing siding until it has authority to proceed. Authority is either timetable schedule (for first-class trains) or a train order (for extras and modified movements).
- The SRRX operates on a meet-and-pass principle at designated sidings. In the event of a simulated meet, the inferior train shall take the siding and clear the main before the superior train's scheduled arrival time.

- Timetable schedules and designated meet points are defined in the Operating Timetable. [OPERATING TIMETABLE — TO BE DEVELOPED] See Appendix for current schedule.

7.3. Mainline Movement Rules

The Silver Ridge Railway mainline forms a continuous loop between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge town, with two distinct routes. Both pass through tunnels under Silver Ridge Mountain — but different ones, at different points in the run.

*The **River Subdivision (River Run)** departs the PVJ yard eastbound, enters the outer tunnel almost immediately, and loops around to emerge heading south along the east leg. From there it passes below Timberline Lumber, follows the Silver Ridge River valley south, and enters Silver Ridge from the east.*

*The **Scenic Subdivision (Scenic Run)** departs PVJ westbound, loops around the west end of the north leg, and passes under the mine spur — which has climbed to elevation above it by this point. It reverses direction and enters the team track to service the warehouse and pick up whatever is waiting for it. The consist then heads northeast into the inner tunnel, loops around to exit heading southwest, and continues through the National Park District past Timberline Fuel Depot turnout, stopping to set out or spot cars as required, then continues south across the Silver Ridge Gorge before entering Silver Ridge from the west.*

The River Run is the working route — Timberline Lumber, the river valley, a straightforward run into town. The Scenic Run is the scenic route — tunnel loop, National Park, gorge crossing — and it is the designated path of the Valley Flyer. Neither route is operationally preferred for freight. The train order governs.

- All mainline movements shall be authorized before the locomotive leaves the terminal or siding. No train shall enter the mainline on assumption.
- The mainline is single track throughout. Only one train may occupy a mainline block at a time. Meets and passes shall occur at designated sidings only.
- At the start of each operating session, the dispatcher shall assign a route — River Run or Scenic Run — to each scheduled train. Route assignments shall be issued as part of the train order. A train shall not change route mid-run without a new order.
- The River Run serves Timberline Lumber on the east leg. Setouts and pickups for Timberline Lumber shall be made on the River Run unless a specific train order authorizes otherwise.
- The Scenic Run serves the Timberline Fuel Depot turnout and crosses the Silver Ridge Gorge. It is the designated route for the Valley Flyer in all normal operations. The gorge crossing is a restricted speed zone. See Rule 7.5.
- The Silver Ridge Mine is served by a separate spur off the north leg. Mine run movements operate independently of the mainline loop and are governed under Rule 7.7. A mine run shall clear the north leg and be staged at PVJ before a mainline departure is authorized on the same segment.
- Freight trains may operate on either route as assigned. Where a freight movement and the Valley Flyer are both scheduled, the freight shall be routed on the River Run where practical, keeping the two trains on separate segments.
- All mainline movements shall approach turnouts at switching speed before the points. A turnout shall not be taken at track speed unless specifically designated as a high-speed crossover.
- In the event of a simulated delay — equipment failure, schedule conflict, or operational hold — the affected train shall clear the mainline and take the nearest available siding before stopping.

- Designated meet points, passing sidings, and route-specific running times are listed in the Operating Timetable. [TIMETABLE APPENDIX PENDING]

7.4. Yard Operations — Pine Valley Junction

Pine Valley Junction yard is not a large facility. It handles what it needs to handle — classification, interchange, engine staging, and departure — with a handful of tracks and whatever power is available. Formal yard hierarchy gives way to practical problem-solving. The goal at the start of every session is simple: the right cars on the right train, pointed the right direction, with a clear path out.

- The 70-Ton GE switcher is the preferred yard power at PVJ. When it is available and operational, road units are kept clear of yard work. When it is not, the road unit does the work — that is the nature of a shortline.
- Track assignments at PVJ are working guidelines, not fixed designations. The Helper Engine Pocket, Team Track, and yard leads reflect normal practice. When space is tight, cars go where they fit and the crew works around it.
- Cars destined for D&RGW interchange shall be identified and spotted as a group before the session ends. Exact track placement depends on available space. The intent is that interchange cars are findable and accessible, not buried behind working freight.
- The Helper Engine Pocket is the preferred staging location for a helper assigned to mine duty. If the pocket is occupied or blocked, the helper may stage on any available clear track at the east end of the yard.
- A train shall be assembled and inspected before departure. All cars in consist order, locomotive coupled, departure route clear. This does not require a formal checklist — it requires that the crew has eyes on the train before it moves.
- Yard limits extend to the east end of the yard lead. Road trains entering yard limits shall reduce speed and give way to any switching movement in progress. When both a road movement and a yard movement need the same track, the road movement waits.
- Engine servicing at PVJ is performed at the fuel and sand facilities adjacent to the yard office. [FACILITY PLACEMENT TO BE CONFIRMED IN SECTION 5] A locomotive assigned to a road run shall be serviced before departure when practical. On a busy session, the crew uses judgment.

7.5. Speed Restrictions

The Silver Ridge Railway is not a fast railroad. The territory does not permit it — tunnels, river crossings, steep mine grades, and tight curves through the National Park District all demand that crews run with judgment rather than speed. The restrictions below are standing orders. They apply every session, every movement, without exception.

- Track speed on the mainline is the maximum permitted in open territory with no other restriction in effect. Track speed is not a target — it is a ceiling. Crews are expected to run at a pace appropriate to the consist, the grade, and the conditions.
- Switching speed applies at all times within yard limits, on all industry spurs, at all turnouts, and on the mine spur. A movement at switching speed is a movement under full control — able to stop within half the visible track ahead.
- The Silver Ridge Gorge bridge is a restricted zone. All movements — freight and passenger — shall reduce to switching speed before the bridge approach and maintain switching speed for the full crossing. No exceptions.

- Both tunnels on the north leg shall be entered at reduced speed. A train shall be under control before the tunnel portal and shall not accelerate until clear of the far portal. This applies in both directions on both bores.
- The mine spur grade is the steepest operation on the railroad. Loaded ore movements descending the grade shall be taken at minimum speed. A loaded car shall never be allowed to roll free on the mine grade. Helper engine operations on the mine grade are governed under Rule 7.7.
- The National Park District curves on the Scenic Run require reduced speed throughout the district. The Valley Flyer, despite its passenger status, is not exempt from this restriction — smooth operation through the curves is preferred over schedule recovery speed.
- Approach speed to any turnout, siding, or industry lead shall be reduced before the points. A train shall not arrive at a turnout at track speed and expect to stop in time. The crew sets the approach, not the brake.
- Speed restrictions are in effect regardless of DCC throttle setting or consist weight. When in doubt, slow down. [SPECIFIC SCALE SPEED BENCHMARKS TO BE ESTABLISHED DURING LAYOUT COMMISSIONING — UPDATE THIS SECTION AT THAT TIME]

7.6. Valley Flyer Operating Priority

The Valley Flyer is the Silver Ridge Railway's passenger and express service, operating between the Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge depots via the Scenic Subdivision (Scenic Run) — through the National Park District, past the Timberline Fuel Depot, and across the gorge. It carries tourists, mail, and light express freight. It is the public face of the railroad in the valley, and it runs on time.

On a shortline where freight pays the bills, giving a passenger train first priority is a statement of character. The Flyer earns its place — the express revenue, the goodwill of the National Park concession, the tourist trade. It does not wait for ore cars.

- The Valley Flyer holds first-class timetable authority on all mainline segments. No freight movement, extra, or mine run shall occupy or block the Flyer's route when the Flyer is within its schedule window.
- The Scenic Run is the Flyer's designated path in all normal operations. A freight train assigned to the Scenic Run shall complete its movement or take a siding before the Flyer's departure window opens. It shall not be in the Flyer's path.
- Occasionally, the Flyer will choose to do the River Run to add variety to the passenger experience. This will not be a regularly scheduled run, but at the discretion of the Dispatch and passenger request.
- At Pine Valley Junction, the Flyer's departure track shall be clear and ready before any other outbound movement is staged. The Flyer loads and departs first. Freight work resumes after it clears the yard limits.
- At Silver Ridge depot, the Flyer has priority access to the station platform. Freight cars shall not occupy the platform track when the Flyer is due. If the platform track is occupied, the freight movement shall be cleared before the Flyer's arrival window.
- In the event of a session where the Valley Flyer is not operated — no consist assembled, no operator available — freight movements may use the Scenic Run freely. The Flyer's priority is only active when the Flyer is running.
- The Valley Flyer consist is: F9A locomotive, passenger coach, observation car. The consist shall be assembled and inspected at PVJ before departure. A Flyer that departs without its full consist is not the Flyer — it is a locomotive movement and holds no special priority.

- Scheduled departure and arrival times for the Valley Flyer are established in the Operating Timetable. [TIMETABLE APPENDIX PENDING] Until the timetable is formalized, the Flyer departs PVJ at the start of the operating session and returns on a reasonable running time as agreed by the crew.

7.7. Helper Engine Operations — Silver Ridge Mine

The Silver Ridge Mine spur climbs from the north leg mainline through three switchback legs connected by two turnouts, rising at grades between 2.6% and 3.3%. There is no runaround at the mine. The mine can spot two cars comfortably, three at a push depending on car length. These are the facts that govern helper operations — the rules below follow from them.

- Helper engine assignments are made at Pine Valley Junction. The assigned helper is staged in the Helper Engine Pocket at the east end of the PVJ yard, clear of all mainline and yard leads, until called for service.
- A helper shall not depart the pocket without a train order authorizing the movement. The order shall identify the train to be assisted and confirm the consist size — no more than three cars, typically two.
- **Ascending with empties — standard movement:** Helper engines assigned to the mine run perform two functions in a single cycle. On the uphill movement, the helper pushes the consist from the helper pocket at PVJ up the mine branch switchbacks to the Silver Ridge Mine. The helper cuts away at the first or second switchback, while empties are spotted and loaded cars are picked up.
- Once cut away, the helper holds on the switchback leg, clear of the turnout it just cleared, and waits. Once released, if there are empty cars at the smelter, the helper first picks them up at the smelter and takes them to the yard at PVJ. It then returns light to the turnout on the mine spur waiting to assist with the loaded cars coming from the mine.
- On the downhill movement with the loaded consist, the helper is not required, the grade works in the train's favor and the road engine provides braking control through the switchbacks. At the base of the switchbacks, at the smelter branch turnout, the helper rejoins the consist on the downhill end. Both engines push the loaded cars up the smelter spur grade to the smelter.
- The helper then returns light to the helper pocket, either coupled to the road engine or running separately, at the crew's discretion. Under no circumstances does the helper attempt the loaded smelter grade alone.
- The helper cut point is the crew's call. With two light empties on a cooperative day, cutting at the first turnout is reasonable. With three cars or difficult conditions, the helper stays coupled through the second turnout before cutting away. The grades are 2.7%, 3.3%, and 2.6% on the three legs respectively — the middle leg is the hardest, and the helper's job is to get the consist through it.
- **Descending with loaded ore cars — road engine only:** There is no helper on the loaded descent. The road engine climbs empty to the mine, couples to the loaded cars, and works the consist back down through the switchbacks under its own control. The engine pulls the first leg leading into the tunnel, pushes through to the next turnout, then pulls back to the turnout where the helper engine is waiting. Both engines then push the loaded cars to the smelter. Loaded cars on the descent shall be taken at minimum speed at all times. The crew controls the movement. No car rolls free on this grade.
- The mine has no runaround. Once the road engine is coupled to the loaded cars it is committed to the descent movement. All switching at the mine — spotting empties, pulling loads — shall be planned before the engine couples up. There is no room to reconsider once the cars are attached.

- Mine consist size: two cars is the working standard. Three cars is the maximum and requires confirming clear spotting space before the movement begins. A consist of three cars on the 3.3% middle leg is the most demanding movement on the railroad — treat it accordingly.
- NE corner access note: The mine spur switchbacks have limited reach from the aisle. **[CONFIRM REACH CLEARANCE DURING LAYOUT CONSTRUCTION]** Helper coupling, uncoupling, and car spotting at the mine should be planned as a deliberate, unhurried operation. An uncoupling tool is recommended.
- **Helper engine selection:** the 70-Ton GE switcher is the standard helper for typical mine consists of two cars. Three-car consists or difficult conditions may warrant a road unit as helper. The crew assigns appropriate power at PVJ before the movement begins.

7.8. Radio and Communication

On a shortline like the SRRX, radio is how the railroad talks to itself. The dispatcher at PVJ talks to the road crew on the mainline. The road crew talks to the helper on the mine grade. Nobody is guessing what the other end is doing. In single-operator sessions, radio discipline is a habit of mind rather than a literal requirement — but the language and the discipline are worth maintaining. It keeps the operation feeling like a railroad.

- The SRRX operates on a single assigned radio channel for all train and yard communications. All operators on the layout use the same channel. Side conversations and non-operational chatter shall use a separate channel or be held off radio.
- Assigned operating channel: **[TO BE ASSIGNED — COORDINATE WITH LAYOUT ROOM SETUP]** All throttles and any radio equipment shall be set to this channel before operations begin.
- Standard SRRX radio calls use the railroad name and train or unit identifier. A road crew calls themselves by train number. The yard calls itself as 'Pine Valley.' The helper identifies as 'Helper.' Example: 'Pine Valley, this is the Flyer, ready to depart.' 'Helper, road engine, ready to couple.'
- All movement authorities — train orders, track clearances, departure releases — shall be confirmed by radio before the movement begins. An authority given and not acknowledged is not an authority in effect.
- On the mine grade, the road engine and helper shall maintain radio contact throughout the ascent. The helper shall confirm cut-away by radio before releasing from the consist. The road engine acknowledges before proceeding to the mine.
- The Valley Flyer crew shall radio PVJ on departure and on arrival at Silver Ridge. This is a schedule confirmation, not a request for authority — the Flyer holds timetable authority. The call keeps the dispatcher informed of the Flyer's position on the layout.
- In single-operator sessions, radio protocol is observed internally — the operator speaks the calls, acknowledges the moves, and maintains the discipline of position reporting even without a second crew. This is not mandatory, but it is strongly encouraged. It builds the operational habits that multi-operator sessions depend on.
- Engine Driver (DCC throttle app) communications are handled via the layout wifi network. **[DEDICATED ANDROID DEVICE STILL NEEDED — CURRENT PHONE HAS WIFI/INTERNET CONFLICT]** Until resolved, single-throttle operation only.
- In the event of a lost radio contact or throttle dropout during a movement, the train stops and holds position until communication is restored. A train without communication does not proceed.

7.9. Fouling Points and Clearance Rules

A fouling point is the location beyond which a car or locomotive occupying one track will interfere with movement on an adjacent track. On a compact N scale layout, fouling points are closer than they feel. The SRRX has limited track space throughout — at PVJ, at the mine, at Silver Ridge depot, at every industry spur. Clearance discipline is not a formality. It is what keeps equipment on the rails and out of each other's way.

- A car or locomotive is clear of a turnout when its full length — including couplers — is beyond the fouling point of that turnout. Trucks and couplers overhang; the body of the car alone is not the measure of clearance.
- Before any turnout is thrown, the operator shall visually confirm that all equipment on both routes is clear of the fouling point. A turnout is never thrown against an occupied track without first confirming clearance.
- At Pine Valley Junction, the yard leads and departure tracks are compact. A car spotted on an adjacent track may foul the lead even when it appears clear. When in doubt at PVJ, walk the track before moving the switch. Eyes on the equipment, not the throttle.
- Industry spurs throughout the railroad — Timberline Lumber, Timberline Fuel Depot, Silver Ridge depot, the mine — are short by design. Spotting a car on a spur shall include confirming that the car clears the mainline or lead it was pulled from. A spotted car that fouls the main is not spotted — it is a problem.
- The Silver Ridge Gorge bridge has no room for error on approach or departure. Equipment shall be fully clear of the bridge approach turnout before any switch is thrown at that location. The gorge crossing is treated as a restricted clearance zone.
- Fouling points at PVJ and all industry locations shall be physically marked on the layout during construction. **[FOULING POINT MARKERS TO BE INSTALLED DURING TRACK LAYING — CONFIRM LOCATIONS AGAINST FINAL TRACK PLAN]** Until marked, operators shall apply a conservative estimate and verify visually.
- On the mine spur switchbacks, each leg is a clearance point for the leg above and below it. A consist reversing through a turnout shall be confirmed clear of the previous leg before the turnout is thrown for the next movement. There is no room on the mine grade to recover from a fouling error.
- In multi-operator sessions, no operator shall throw a turnout on another operator's active segment without first communicating the intent and receiving acknowledgment. Turnout authority follows the train — the crew working a segment controls its switches.
- A derailment at or near a turnout shall be treated as a potential fouling event. Operations on adjacent tracks shall pause until the derailed equipment is rerailed and confirmed clear of all fouling points before resuming.

SECTION 8 – Train Movements and Switching Guides

The Silver Ridge Railway exists because of geography. The mountain between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge is not a barrier that roads have solved — not reliably, not year-round, and not for the tonnage that keeps the communities on both sides of it alive. The mine needs its empties and needs its loads taken away. The smelter needs its chemical inputs. The Fuel Depot needs tank cars. The town of Silver Ridge needs lumber, dry goods, mail, and the kind of bulk freight that a mountain road cannot carry in January. The national park needs its service materials. None of this moves efficiently without the railroad, and the railroad exists to move all of it.

Section 8 is the operational playbook for how that work gets done. Where Section 7 establishes the rules, Section 8 describes the practice — how trains are assembled, how cars are worked, and how the railroad fulfills its obligations to the customers and communities it serves. The procedures here are written for the crew that already knows the Rule Book. They assume that authority has been obtained, that the mainline is clear, and that the basic disciplines of Section 7 are second nature. What follows is the work itself.

8.1. The Mine Run

The Mine Run is the Silver Ridge Railway's most demanding regular movement, and the one that most clearly defines what kind of railroad the SRRX is. It requires two engines, covers three switchback legs on grades that reach 3.3 percent, and offers no runaround at the top. Every decision about car counts and cut points has to be made before the road engine leaves Pine Valley Junction, because there is no room for improvisation once the consist is on the mountain.

The run is a two-engine operation. The road engine is the primary motive power, it makes the climb, works the mine, and brings the loaded cars back down to the smelter. The helper is needed for the ascent, providing additional push on the lower grade before cutting off. It is also used to assist in pushing the loaded cars to the smelter.

The mine spur leaves the north leg in the northeast corner of the layout and climbs in three switchback legs through two turnouts to the mine terminus at the base of Silver Ridge Mountain. The grades — 2.7, 3.3, and 2.6 percent across the three legs respectively — are manageable for a properly sized consist but unforgiving of sloppy car handling or slack running. The standard consist is two cars. Three is the maximum, and that decision belongs to the road engine crew before departure, not on the mountain.

At the mine terminus there are two tracks. Spur A is the active track — loaded ore cars staged and ready for pickup. Spur B is the holding track, where empty cars wait until they can be repositioned for the next loading cycle. The distinction matters because there is no runaround at the top. The road engine arrives with empties, spots them to Spur B, then repositions to couple onto the loads on Spur A. The sequence has to work in that order every time.

Departing PVJ, the road engine leads the empty consist onto the mine spur with the helper coupled to the rear, pushing from behind. Together they work the lower leg at restricted speed — no slack running on grade — up to the first switchback turnout. This is where the helper cuts off. The standard cut point is Turnout 1, though the crew may elect Turnout 2 if the grade or consist weight warrants. The call belongs to the road engine crew, confirmed by radio before uncoupling. Once the helper cuts off, it descends light to the turnout for the smelter. If there are empty cars at the smelter, the helper ascends to pick them up and take them to PVJ yard and returns to the smelter turnout. The mine spur above Turnout 1 belongs to the road engine from that point forward.

The road engine works the remaining two legs alone, reversing direction at each switchback. Restricted speed through both upper legs, no exceptions. At the mine terminus the engine spots the empties to Spur B, clears the turnout, and couples onto the loaded cars on Spur A. Brakes are tested before the descent

begins. The road engine brings the loaded consist back down through the switchback to the turnout for the Silver Smelter. The helper and road engine then push the loaded cars to the smelter.

The mine spurs do not reset themselves. With loaded cars removed and empties sitting on Spur B, the tracks need to be repositioned before the next revenue pull can happen.

Two operational constraints govern every Mine Run without exception. There is no runaround at the mine terminus under any circumstances, which means the spotting sequence — empties to Spur B before coupling to loads on Spur A — is not optional. And the mine spur above the cut point is single-engine territory once the helper has descended.

8.2. The Valley Flyer

The Valley Flyer is a different kind of railroad from everything else in Section 8. The ore trains and the local freights exist to move tonnage. The Flyer exists to move people, and it does so on a schedule that the rest of the railroad is obligated to respect. Its operating pattern is determined entirely by one constraint: the observation car at the Pine Valley Junction end of the consist has no rear coupler, and that fact governs every movement the Flyer makes.

The consist is assembled in a fixed order that does not change: observation car — coach — F9A locomotive. The observation car is always at the PVJ end. The F9A is always at the Silver Ridge end. There is no runaround that can change this, and none is needed — the railroad is built around it. [F9A #215 kit — extended run test required before regular service; white gear risk, no sustained high-speed running until assessed] The coach handles passenger traffic and express and mail duties from its baggage section. The observation car's open platform faces Pine Valley Junction, which means passengers boarding at PVJ step onto the platform end first — not the worst way to begin a journey.

Departing PVJ southbound on the Scenic Run, the F9A pulls. The consist is drawn out of the station spur — the right-hand spur at Pine Valley Junction, the red depot building at the platform — and eastbound onto the mainline. [Station spur extension likely required at construction for full consist with 72-foot passenger cars — confirm at track laying] The F9A leads through the inner tunnel, emerges southwesterly, and pulls the consist down through the National Park District, past the Timberline Fuel Depot turnout, and across the Silver Ridge Gorge bridge. The observation car trails at the rear on this leg, its platform open to the receding view behind the train. The Flyer arrives at Silver Ridge from the west, F9A at the head end, observation car at the platform.

The gorge crossing southbound is experienced from the rear of the train — passengers on the observation platform watch the canyon open up behind them as the consist crosses. It is not the forward view, but it is not a poor substitute. The bridge carries the consist over the river canyon at restricted speed, which is the only appropriate pace for a crossing that most passengers came specifically to see.

Departing Silver Ridge northbound on the Scenic Run, the F9A pushes. The observation car now leads — it exits Silver Ridge first, crosses the Gorge bridge with the open platform facing forward into the canyon, and climbs back through the National Park District toward PVJ. This is the direction in which the observation car earns its name. The forward view through the gorge approach northbound, from an open platform, is the signature experience of the Valley Flyer. The F9A pushes from the Silver Ridge end, invisible to the passengers watching the landscape unfold ahead of them.

The Flyer re-enters the inner tunnel from the south, the observation car leading, and emerges onto the north leg heading toward PVJ. The consist is pushed into the station spur, observation car entering first, F9A last. The round trip is complete with the consist in its correct orientation for the next southbound departure — observation car at the PVJ platform end, F9A ready to pull.

On occasions when the Flyer returns to PVJ via the River Run rather than the Scenic Run — the long way round, up the east leg and through the outer tunnel — the movement begins the same way, F9A pushing northbound out of Silver Ridge. The F9A pulls once the consist is on the east leg heading north, drawing the train up past Timberline Lumber, through the outer tunnel in the northeast corner, and around the north leg loop toward PVJ. The consist is then shoved into the station spur from the mainline, observation car entering first, restoring the correct departure orientation. The River Run return is the exception rather than the rule, but the consist handles it without difficulty.

The Flyer makes no scheduled intermediate stops. On summer excursion runs, the crew may authorize a discretionary photo hold at the Silver Ridge Gorge — a pause long enough for passengers to take in the canyon from the observation platform or, when the platform is in place, to detrain to the viewpoint. [Gorge platform — construction pending; north rim board platform with steps and path to viewpoint] The hold may be taken on the mainline with the consist clear of the Silver Ridge turnout fouling point, or the consist may be reversed into the Timberline Fuel Depot spur — observation car entering first regardless of direction — with the spur confirmed clear of spotted tank cars before committing. The F9A pulls the consist back onto the mainline when the stop is complete and resumes in the original direction of travel. The discretionary stop is a crew decision, not a timetable event.

The Valley Flyer holds first-class authority over the Scenic Run for the full duration of its movement. All freight movements must be clear of the mainline before the Flyer's authority window opens. [Timetable appendix pending — train numbers and departure times to be assigned at formalization per Section 7.2] Until the timetable is formalized, the practical authority provisions of Section 7.6 apply and verbal crew coordination governs.

8.3. Local Freight — River Run (Timberline Lumber)

The Timberline Lumber local is the River Run's primary freight assignment and one of the simpler movements on the railroad, at least in principle. The work is straightforward — pull loaded cars from the lumber spur, return empties — but the geometry of the spur and the absence of a runaround at Timberline means the move has to be thought through before the engine leaves Pine Valley Junction, in the same way the Mine Run does.

The River Run is the clockwise route, eastbound out of PVJ on the north leg, through the outer tunnel in the northeast corner, emerging southbound on the east leg. Timberline Lumber sits on the east leg with the spur above the mainline on a climbing grade. The freight engine arrives from the north, having come down the east leg from the tunnel. It arrives at Timberline with the spur ahead and to the right.

The current track at Timberline Lumber has a single spur. [Second spot at Timberline Lumber still needed — loading track and empties track; confirm space at construction] Until a second spur is in place, the operation runs as a two-visit cycle, parallel to the mine run logic. On the first visit, the road engine pulls the loaded cars off the spur and takes them back to PVJ. On a separate movement — scheduled when traffic permits — the engine returns with empties and spots them to the spur for the next loading cycle. The lumber crew loads on their own schedule; the railroad's job is to ensure empty cars are on the spur when loading is ready and to pull the loads when they are.

The pull is the simpler of the two moves. The road engine arrives light or with an empty consist from PVJ, couples onto the loaded cars on the spur, and departs southbound to continue down the east leg to Silver Ridge, or returns northbound to PVJ depending on the day's work order. Car forwarding from Timberline is typically a PRR flatcar with lumber load outbound and an MTL gondola inbound for lumber waste or secondary material. The waybill governs.

The spotting move requires more care. The road engine arrives from PVJ with empty cars, pulls past the Timberline turnout, reverses, and shoves the empties into the spur. Without a runaround the engine has

to push the cars in from whichever direction it arrived — which means the shove is northbound if the engine came down the east leg from the tunnel, or southbound if it came up from Silver Ridge. Either way, the engine ends up at the uphill end of the spur after spotting, which is the correct position for the next pull. [Fouling point marker at Timberline Lumber spur — install at track laying per Section 7.9]

The Timberline Lumber local does not have the drama of the Mine Run or the priority of the Valley Flyer. It is a workday job on a quiet piece of railroad, and it runs on the lumber operation's schedule as much as the railroad's own. When the mill is running, the cars need to be there. That is the whole of it.

8.4. Local Freight — Scenic Run (Timberline Fuel Depot)

The Scenic Run local is the railroad's other regular freight assignment, and in some ways the more varied of the two. Where the River Run exists primarily to serve Timberline Lumber, the Scenic Run local works. The engine works whatever needs working in whichever direction it is traveling, spots and pulls handled as the work order dictates rather than on a fixed sequence.

The Scenic Run departs PVJ westbound from the yard, enters the inner tunnel on the north leg, and emerges southwesterly to begin the descent toward Silver Ridge. The first customer southbound is the Timberline Fuel Depot. The Fuel Depot receives Shell tank cars primarily, with Dow and Hooker cars as secondary traffic depending on the season and the depot's needs. The spur stub accommodates two tank cars. The engine spots or pulls as the work order requires, clears the turnout, and continues south toward Silver Ridge or returns north to PVJ depending on what remains on the day's list.

Northbound out of Silver Ridge, the same logic applies. The engine works what needs working and leaves what does not. On days when the depot has cars to pull and empties to spot, the Scenic Run local can be the busiest movement on the railroad. On quiet days it may pass this facility without stopping, the work order empty and the mainline clear all the way back to PVJ.

The Valley Flyer's authority over the Scenic Run is the one constraint that governs every Scenic Run freight movement without exception. The local must be clear of the mainline — not merely moving, but clear — before the Flyer's authority window opens. A freight engine spotted in a spur with cars hanging over the mainline is not clear. The Flyer does not slow for freight, and the Scenic Run has no place to hide a consist if the timing is wrong. [Timetable appendix pending — Scenic Run freight windows to be scheduled around Valley Flyer departure times at formalization per Section 7.2] Until the timetable is formalized, verbal coordination between crews applies.

The Scenic Run local is also the movement most likely to encounter the discretionary Gorge photo stop if the Valley Flyer is running that day. The freight crew should know the Flyer's schedule and plan accordingly — the Gorge and the Fuel Depot spur are both on this line, and a freight engine in the wrong place at the wrong time is an embarrassment the SRRX's flagship passenger service does not deserve. [Fouling point markers Timberline Fuel Depot spur — install at track laying per Section 7.9]

8.5. PVJ Yard Switching

Pine Valley Junction is not a large yard. It was never meant to be. The Silver Ridge Railway exists to serve a mine, a handful of industries, and a passenger run through the mountains, and the yard at PVJ reflects that mission without apology. There are no long classification leads, no dedicated departure tracks, no hump. What there is, is enough — enough track to assemble the day's work, enough room to sort the interchange cuts, and a mainline long enough to serve as the yard's extended arm when the situation calls for it.

No. 98 is the yard engine. The 70-Ton GE handles all switching at PVJ between road assignments, spotting cars to departure tracks, pulling inbound cuts apart, and keeping the station spur clear for the Valley Flyer. It is a capable machine for the work the yard demands of it, and the yard demands nothing it cannot handle.

When No. 98 is away on the mine switcher run, the road engine covers any switching that cannot wait, though that situation is uncommon enough that it rarely creates a conflict.

The yard's daily rhythm follows the railroad's traffic. Morning typically begins with No. 98 sorting whatever arrived on the previous day's interchange or inbound freight movements — pulling cars to their departure tracks, spotting empties for the outbound runs, and confirming the station spur is clear and the Valley Flyer consist is properly assembled before the first departure window opens. The Flyer's priority means that nothing else in the yard takes precedence over having the station spur ready on time. A freight car left fouling the station track is No. 98's problem to solve before it becomes the Flyer's problem.

Classification at PVJ is simple by design. The railroad's industries each receive a small number of cars per cycle — rarely more than two or three — and the car forwarding is straightforward enough that a single switcher can sort an entire day's work without difficulty. Cars for the River Run are assembled on one track, cars for the Scenic Run on another, and interchange traffic is held near the NW corner where the D&RGW connection sits. The mainline serves as the sorting lead when the available yard tracks are occupied or when a move requires more room than the classification tracks provide. On a quiet railroad with light traffic, using the mainline for switching is not an embarrassment — it is simply practical.

The interchange at the far northwest corner of the layout is the yard's connection to the outside world. Cars forwarded to the D&RGW are spotted at the interchange track for pickup; inbound cars from the interchange are pulled by No. 98 and sorted into the yard for distribution to the railroad's customers. The interchange is addressed in detail in Section 8.6, but its presence shapes the yard's switching logic — interchange cuts arriving from outside tend to be the largest movements PVJ handles, and on occasions when a cut exceeds the yard's available track length, cars may be set out on the mainline temporarily while No. 98 works the consist down to manageable pieces. Traffic on the north leg is light enough that a brief mainline set-out is an inconvenience rather than a crisis, provided the road crew communicates clearly and clears the mainline before any scheduled movement has authority.

The helper engine pocket on the north side of the yard is No. 98's staging point between the mine helper assignment and yard duty. When No. 98 returns from the mountain it goes to the pocket, not back into the classification tracks. Keeping the helper staged and ready is a discipline that pays off when the road engine is ready to depart for the mine and No. 98 needs to couple on without delay. A switcher that has been pressed into classification work and left on the wrong track is a switcher that makes the Mine Run late.

The warehouse at PVJ sits within the yard and generates its own modest switching requirement — cars spotted for goods transfer to or from the interchange, local freight consignments, and express material that moves through the depot rather than the Flyer's baggage section. The warehouse is not a high-volume customer, but it anchors the yard's identity as something more than a place where trains begin and end. PVJ is a working facility, and the warehouse is part of that work.

The yard is, in the end, a reflection of the railroad it serves. It is not impressive by any measure that a large railroad would apply. But it handles everything the Silver Ridge Railway asks of it, and on a shortline that prides itself on running what it has with what it has, that is the only measure that matters. [Fuel and sand facility placement at PVJ — confirm against Section 5 at revision]

8.6. D&RGW Interchange

The Silver Ridge Railway does not exist in isolation. Its freight customers ship product to destinations beyond the mountain, and they receive materials from suppliers who have never heard of Pine Valley Junction. The connection that makes this possible is the interchange with the Denver and Rio Grande Western at the far northwest corner of the PVJ yard — a short track at the edge of the SRRX's world where one railroad ends and another begins.

The D&RGW local does not come deep into PVJ. It reaches the interchange track, sets out its cars, picks up whatever the SRRX has forwarded, and departs. What happens on the D&RGW's side of that boundary is not the SRRX's concern. What happens on this side is entirely No. 98's responsibility.

The interchange track is worked at the start and end of each operating session. Inbound cars — those arriving from the D&RGW overnight — are placed on the interchange track before the session begins. They represent whatever the outside world has sent to the SRRX's customers: hoppers for the mine, tank cars for the Smelter or Fuel Depot, revenue freight for Silver Ridge. No. 98 pulls the inbound cut from the interchange track early in the session, works it into the yard, and sorts the cars to their departure tracks for distribution on the day's outbound movements. Outbound cars accumulate on the interchange track as the session progresses — loads pulled from the mine, empties returning to their home roads, through freight destined for points beyond the mountain. At the session's end those cars are removed. The D&RGW local has been and gone.

The D&RGW's physical presence at PVJ is represented by MoPac #4637. The unit stands in for the interchange power — the engine that brought the inbound cut down from the connection and will take the outbound cars when it departs. It sits at the interchange track during the session, visible at the edge of the yard, a reminder that the SRRX is part of a larger railroad world even if that world never intrudes further than the NW corner. #4637 does not work the SRRX yard. It does not pull cars beyond the interchange track. Its job is to be there, and it does that job without complication.

The car forwarding logic is straightforward. Inbound cars are sorted by destination — mine traffic to the mine run consist and Smelter, and Fuel Depot cars to the Scenic Run local, Silver Ridge freight to the River Run or direct to the town switching assignment. Outbound cars are whatever the day's pulls have produced: loaded ore from the mine forwarded to the smelter and then to the interchange, empties returning to their home roads, any through freight the SRRX is handling on behalf of connecting lines. The waybill governs the detail; the interchange track is simply where the handoff happens.

On occasions when an inbound cut is larger than the interchange track can accommodate, cars may be set out on the PVJ mainline temporarily while No. 98 works the consist down to manageable pieces. This is an uncommon situation on a railroad that receives modest traffic, but it is not unheard of — the D&RGW does not always send a short cut, and the SRRX yard is not infinitely accommodating. The mainline is available for brief set-outs provided all movements are coordinated and the track is clear before any road engine has authority. [\[Dedicated D&RGW interchange track — verify length and placement against final track plan at construction\]](#)

The interchange is the least dramatic operation on the Silver Ridge Railway. No engine works hard, no grade is climbed, no timetable authority is required. But it is the operation that connects everything else the railroad does to the world beyond Pine Valley Junction, and without it the mine's ore goes nowhere, the Smelter's product sits on the siding, and the SRRX is just a railroad running in circles through the mountains. The interchange track at the NW corner of PVJ is a short piece of rail with an outsized purpose.

8.7 Silver Ridge Town Switching

Silver Ridge is the southern terminal of the Silver Ridge Railway and the railroad's most public-facing destination. It began as a mining town, rougher and more functional than it is today, and has evolved over decades into something more complex — a community that serves the national park, welcomes tourists in summer and winter sport visitors in the cold months, houses the railroad's southern workforce, and depends on the SRRX for a category of supply that the mountain road cannot reliably provide. The depot at Silver Ridge is not just a passenger facility. It is the point where the railroad's freight work and its community obligations meet.

The town's road system connects Silver Ridge to the Timberline Fuel Depot, to the lumber operations, and to the national park entrance — a network that functions well enough in good weather and becomes the railroad's argument in bad weather. Fuel arrives by tank car at the Fuel Depot and moves to Silver Ridge by road. Lumber comes down from Timberline the same way. Bulk goods and dry goods arrive by rail at the Silver Ridge depot and are distributed from there. The post office receives its mail from the Flyer's coach baggage section. The brewery takes the occasional grain or hop car when the road from the valley is impassable or the shipment is too large for a truck. The general store orders by the boxcar in late summer, stocking for the winter. None of this is high-volume freight by any railroad's measure, but taken together it represents a community's supply chain, and the SRRX treats it accordingly.

The switching work at Silver Ridge is modest and unhurried. The road engine working the River Run or the Scenic Run handles whatever cars need to be spotted or pulled as part of that movement — there is no dedicated Silver Ridge switcher, and none is needed. A boxcar for the general store, a grain car for the brewery, an empty returned from the previous week's delivery — these are one and two car moves worked at the pace the town sets, not the railroad's. The depot team track accommodates the freight exchange, and the road engine spots or pulls before continuing on its run or returning to PVJ. [\[Dedicated D&RGW interchange track — verify length and placement against final track plan at construction\]](#)

The depot itself is the center of the railroad's presence in Silver Ridge. Passenger arrivals and departures on the Valley Flyer are the most visible part of that presence — the Flyer's arrival is something of an event in a town that does not have many — but the depot's work continues between Flyer movements. Express shipments are sorted, mail is handed off to the post office, park service materials are staged for pickup, and the occasional freight car is worked on the team track. The depot agent at Silver Ridge manages all of it, keeping the railroad's southern end running with the same scrappy competence that characterizes the SRRX at every point on its line.

Silver Ridge is also the Flyer's southern home. The consist spends its downtime here between operating sessions, the observation car at the platform end of the station track, the F9A on the far end ready to pull northbound when the next departure comes. The station track must accommodate the full Flyer consist, and like its counterpart at PVJ, it will likely require extension when full-length passenger cars are in service. [\[Silver Ridge depot team track — extended track or second spur likely needed; confirm at construction\]](#) The mainline runaround at Silver Ridge is available for any movement that requires it — the road engine working the town freight, a meet between opposing movements, or any operational situation that the station track alone cannot resolve.

The town beyond the depot is the reason the railroad matters. The park entrance draws visitors who arrive on the Flyer and leave on it. The hotel and the restaurant fill on summer weekends when the mountain is at its best. The houses along the river, on the good side facing the mountain and the gorge, belong to people who chose Silver Ridge over somewhere easier to reach. The SRRX did not make Silver Ridge what it is. But it is not clear that Silver Ridge would still be what it is without the SRRX, and the railroad understands that. It runs its trains accordingly.

SECTION 9 – Identity, Branding, and Public Presence

The Silver Ridge Railway does not advertise in the conventional sense. It has no marketing department, no agency retainer, and no budget for billboards on the interstate. What it has is a railroad that people remember — a gorge crossing that stays with you, a maroon locomotive working a switchback in the autumn light, a depot agent in Silver Ridge who knows your name by your second visit. The SRRX's public presence is built on those moments, accumulated over decades, and reinforced by a visual identity consistent enough that anyone who has seen the railroad once would recognize it again anywhere along the line.

9.1. Brand Identity

The SRRX's visual identity is anchored in three colors. SRRX Maroon — deep, warm, and unmistakably the railroad's own — covers locomotive bodies, depot signage, and printed materials. SRRX Cream carries all lettering, striping, and herald text, providing clean contrast against the maroon without the harshness of pure white. Safety Yellow appears on handrails, sill stripes, and safety markings, the one concession to functional requirement that the railroad has made a design virtue. Underframes, walkways, and trucks are black throughout. Freight car stenciling uses warm gray, keeping the working fleet visually distinct from the locomotive roster without requiring a separate paint standard.

The herald is a circular badge: maroon field, cream outer ring, the words SILVER RIDGE RAILWAY arching across the top, SRRX centered in cream against a stylized mountain silhouette, two stars flanking the reporting marks. It appears on locomotive noses and rear hoods, caboose sides, depot signage, employee rulebooks, and marketing materials. Freight cars do not receive the herald — reporting marks and road number only, in warm gray or white, weathered as appropriate to a working shortline car. The herald is the railroad's face; the freight fleet is its hands. The distinction is intentional.

Locomotives carry the full scheme: maroon body, thin cream sill stripe, SILVER RIDGE RAILWAY in cream centered on the long hood, reporting marks and road number on the cab sides, herald on nose and rear. Handrails are safety yellow throughout. The caboose follows the locomotive scheme — maroon body, black roof, large SRRX on the sides, small herald near the cupola, safety striping on the steps — maintained to a higher standard than the freight fleet because it is, when the Valley Flyer is running, the most photographed car on the railroad.

Weathering philosophy follows function. Locomotives show moderate grime and honest use — clean lettering, dulled paint, the kind of wear that says the unit is worked hard and maintained well enough to keep working. Freight cars weather heavily, because they are. The Valley Flyer's passenger equipment — the observation car, the coach, the F9B — is kept cleaner than anything else on the roster, not out of vanity but because it represents the railroad to passengers and visitors who will form their opinion of the SRRX from what they see on the platform.

Typography follows the same logic. Depot signage and printed materials use Railroad Roman as the primary face, Block Gothic for stencils and safety signs. Maroon backgrounds with cream lettering carry the brand indoors and out. Safety signs follow standard convention — yellow with black text — regardless of context.

The railroad's public motto is Small Railroad. Big Heart. It appears on the depot bulletin board in Silver Ridge, on the back of the employee timetable, and on the occasional piece of promotional material that finds its way into the hands of park visitors and passing tourists. It is not overstated. It does not need to be.

Full color specifications, hex references, and reproductions of the approved herald variants are provided in the Appendix.

9.2. Public Image and Community Role

The SRRX's public image was not engineered. It accumulated. A railroad that has been running through the same valley for long enough becomes part of the landscape in a way that no marketing campaign can manufacture — and the SRRX has been running long enough. The maroon locomotives are as much a fixture of the Silver Ridge skyline as the mountain itself. The Valley Flyer's schedule anchors the day for a portion of the population that neither rides it regularly nor thinks about it consciously until it is late.

The railroad's relationship with Pine Valley Junction is functional and unsentimental. PVJ is a railroad town and its residents understand the SRRX the way they understand any employer — with a mixture of loyalty, pragmatism, and occasional frustration. The yard is the economic center of the community, and the SRRX's continued viability is not an abstraction there. It is the reason the lights stay on.

Silver Ridge is warmer. The railroad is more visible here, more social, more woven into the texture of daily life in a town that has other things to do besides watch trains. The depot is a public space in a way that PVJ's yard office is not. Tourists come through. Railfans set up on the platform. The Valley Flyer's arrival is a small event in a town that values small events. The SRRX understands this and plays its part without overplaying it — the depot is maintained, the schedules are posted, and the crews are known to wave.

Community outreach takes practical forms: open houses at the engine house when the schedule allows, occasional school visits coordinated through the Silver Ridge school district, participation in the town's summer and winter events when the railroad has something useful to contribute. The SRRX does not sponsor galas or run advertising campaigns. It shows up, does its work visibly and well, and relies on the accumulation of that presence over time. On a railroad this size, in communities this size, that is the only outreach strategy that actually works.

9.3. Tourism and the Valley Flyer

The Valley Flyer is the SRRX's most effective piece of marketing, and it does its work simply by running. Every summer passenger who crosses the gorge on the observation platform and tells someone about it afterward is doing promotion the railroad could not purchase. Every railfan photograph of a maroon F9A pushing through the National Park District curves, posted somewhere on the internet, reaches an audience the SRRX has no other way to address. The Flyer earns its operating priority many times over in visibility alone.

Promotional materials for the Flyer emphasize what cannot be replicated by road: the gorge crossing, the mountain approaches, the unhurried pace of a consist moving through terrain that resists hurry. The language is straightforward — the scenery does not require embellishment, and the SRRX's instinct is to let it speak for itself. Brochures appear at the Silver Ridge depot, at the National Park District visitor center, and at a small number of lodging properties in the region. The design follows the brand: maroon and cream, clean typography, a photograph of the gorge bridge that has been used in one form or another since someone first thought to take it.

The partnership with the National Park District is the railroad's most valuable external relationship, and both institutions know it. The park gains controlled visitor access to terrain that would otherwise require road infrastructure it has no interest in building. The railroad gains right-of-way security, a captive passenger market, and the political legitimacy that comes from being a named partner of a federal agency. Joint signage appears at the Silver Ridge depot and at the gorge overlook platform. Interpretive panels along the Flyer route, coordinated with the park's education staff, give summer passengers context for what they are seeing — the geology of the gorge, the history of the smelter, the ecology of the Timberline district. The railroad contributes the train. The park contributes the story. Between them they have built something neither could have managed alone.

9.4. Special Events and Promotions

The SRRX's event calendar is modest and deliberate. A small number of special movements run each year — a holiday train in December, a photography charter or two in the autumn when the Timberline larches are at their best, an occasional community appreciation run timed to one of Silver Ridge's summer festivals. These events are not loss leaders. They are chosen because they generate goodwill that outlasts the day, and because they give the railroad's crews and its community something to share that a normal ore run cannot provide.

Photography charters are the most operationally interesting of the special events, and the most popular with the railfan community. A charter typically runs the full Scenic loop, with agreed-upon slow orders at the gorge bridge and the mine switchback approach — the two locations that account for the majority of published SRRX photography. The locomotive is cleaned, the consist is assembled to full length, and the crew understands that the pace of the day is the photographer's pace rather than the timetable's. The railroad charges accordingly, and the charters have never lacked for participants.

The holiday train runs point-to-point between PVJ and Silver Ridge, typically in December, with a consist that adds decorated boxcars behind the standard Flyer equipment. It is not an elaborate production. It does not need to be. The combination of maroon locomotives, mountain snow, and a train that shows up on schedule in a community that has been watching for it since childhood is sufficient. The SRRX has been running the holiday train long enough that missing it would be noticed more than running it ever is.

SECTION 10 – Railfan Guide and Photo Locations

The Silver Ridge Railway is not a hidden railroad. It runs through a national park, crosses a gorge that stops conversations, and operates a passenger train that has been putting people on platforms with cameras since before most of its current riders were born. Railfans find the SRRX without much difficulty. This section is for those who want to find it well — at the right location, in the right light, with a reasonable understanding of what they are likely to see and when.

10.1. Safety and Conduct

The SRRX operates on steep grades and tight curves through terrain that does not forgive inattention. Trains move quietly on mountain approaches and may appear with little warning at tunnel portals and curve exits. Visitors must remain clear of all trackage, turnouts, and equipment at all times. The fouling envelope of an N-scale consist on a curve is not intuitive — stand further back than you think you need to.

Within the National Park District, all park service regulations apply in addition to the railroad's own requirements. Designated viewing areas exist for a reason. Scrambling on rock faces above the gorge, climbing structure approaches, or positioning equipment on or near the bridge deck is not permitted under any circumstances. Drones require advance coordination with both the railroad and the National Park District and are subject to seasonal restrictions during fire weather.

The railroad's crews are professionals doing demanding work in difficult terrain. They appreciate acknowledgment and will return it, but they are not tour guides and their attention belongs on the train. Requests to hold movements for photography are not accommodated on regular service. Photography charters exist for that purpose and are announced through the railroad's community channels.

10.2. What Runs and When

The Valley Flyer is the most predictable train on the railroad and the easiest to plan around. Its schedule is posted at both depots and is the master reference for anyone trying to be at a specific location at a specific time. The Flyer operates the full Scenic loop in summer peak season and runs point-to-point between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge in the off-season. Winter sport season brings an uptick in ridership without changing the operating pattern — the Flyer still runs, and it still runs on time.

Freight movements are less predictable but no less worth catching. The mine run is the most operationally distinctive movement on the railroad — two engines departing PVJ, the helper cutting off on the switchback grade, the road engine working alone to the mine terminus and returning with loaded ore cars. It does not run on a published schedule accessible to the public, but it runs regularly, and anyone positioned near the Pine Valley Junction yard throat in the morning has a reasonable chance of seeing it assembled and departing. The local freights on the River Run and the Scenic Run follow the same logic — regular but not clockwork, shaped by the customers' needs as much as the railroad's own plan.

Work extras, snow service trains, and special movements operate as conditions require and offer no advance notice. They are the reward for spending time at a location rather than passing through it.

10.3. Photo Locations

The SRRX concentrates its most photogenic elements in a compact territory, which means a visitor with a full day can cover most of the best locations without difficulty. What follows are the locations that have produced the most enduring photographs of the railroad, in rough order from Pine Valley Junction south and west.

The PVJ Yard Throat. The yard at Pine Valley Junction is not scenic in any conventional sense, but it is the operational heart of the railroad and the place where trains are made. The tunnel portals at the east

end of the yard — the outer portal leading to the River Run, the inner portal leading to the Scenic Run — frame departing trains in a way that rewards patience. Morning light from the east catches locomotives head-on as they enter the outer tunnel. The helper engine pocket is visible from the yard approach, and catching No. 98 coupled to the rear of a mine consist before departure is one of the more satisfying two-engine photographs the railroad offers.

The Mine Switchback District. The switchbacks are the railroad's most distinctive operational feature and its most technically demanding photography subject. Three legs, two reversals, grades that reach 3.3 percent — the geometry produces a scene where a patient observer can watch the same train from the same position reversing direction twice on the face of the mountain. Afternoon light works best here, raking across the switchback legs and defining the elevation changes. Access is limited by terrain; the designated viewing area above the first switchback turnout provides the most complete view of the district without requiring the observer to leave established ground.

Timberline Lumber on the East Leg. The Timberline Lumber spur climbs above the mainline on a visible grade, and a locomotive working cars up or down that spur against the backdrop of the Silver Ridge River valley below produces a photograph that reads immediately as mountain railroading. The light on the east leg favors morning for southbound movements and late afternoon for the return. The spur itself is short and the switching moves are deliberate — there is time to compose a shot here in a way the gorge does not always allow.

The National Park District Curves. The Scenic Run through the National Park District is sustained scenic running without switching — the train moves through the landscape rather than working it. The curves through the lower park corridor, with the mountain rising to the east and the valley opening to the west, are where the Valley Flyer photographs best as a complete train rather than a detail. Summer light through the park is long and forgiving. Autumn is the season most returning visitors cite as their reason for coming back.

The Silver Ridge Gorge Bridge. This is the photograph that defines the railroad in the public mind, and it delivers reliably. The bridge carries the mainline over the Silver Ridge River canyon on a high steel span with open air in both directions. The Valley Flyer crosses at restricted speed — which is, from a photography standpoint, the only appropriate pace for a subject this good. The gorge overlook platform on the north rim provides the canonical vantage point: elevation above the bridge deck, clear sightlines in both directions, and enough distance to include the canyon walls in the frame. Morning light is flat here; midday and afternoon light picks up the canyon walls and the river below. The Flyer crosses southbound with the F9A leading and the observation car trailing. Northbound, the observation car leads and the F9A pushes from the Silver Ridge end — a less conventional image but one that experienced photographers prefer for its rarity.

The Gorge Flagstop. For photographers who want a subject that combines the railroad with the gorge landscape at ground level rather than from an overlook, the Gorge Flagstop siding offers a rare opportunity. The Gorge-ous Grub caboose and the picnic clearing provide a foreground, the gorge rim provides depth, and the Valley Flyer arriving at reduced speed for its scheduled stop provides the subject. The stop is brief and the light at the gorge is best in afternoon when the canyon walls are illuminated from the west. The siding is accessible only during flagstop hours in summer full-loop season.

Silver Ridge Depot. The south end of the railroad is the place to photograph the Flyer as a passenger train rather than a landscape element — people on the platform, the depot building in the background, the consist at rest between runs. The town loop and the passing siding give a locomotive room to move without the constraints of the gorge or the switchbacks, and a road engine working the town freight on the team track provides unhurried switching photography at a pace the mine run never allows. Late afternoon light from the west catches the maroon equipment at its best.

10.4. Seasonal Notes

Spring brings snowmelt runoff to the Silver Ridge River and occasional late snow at mine elevation. The gorge runs high and fast, and the contrast between the river below and the bridge deck above is at its most dramatic. Light is clear and cold. The Flyer returns to full loop operation as conditions allow, and the first full-loop run of the season is worth being present for.

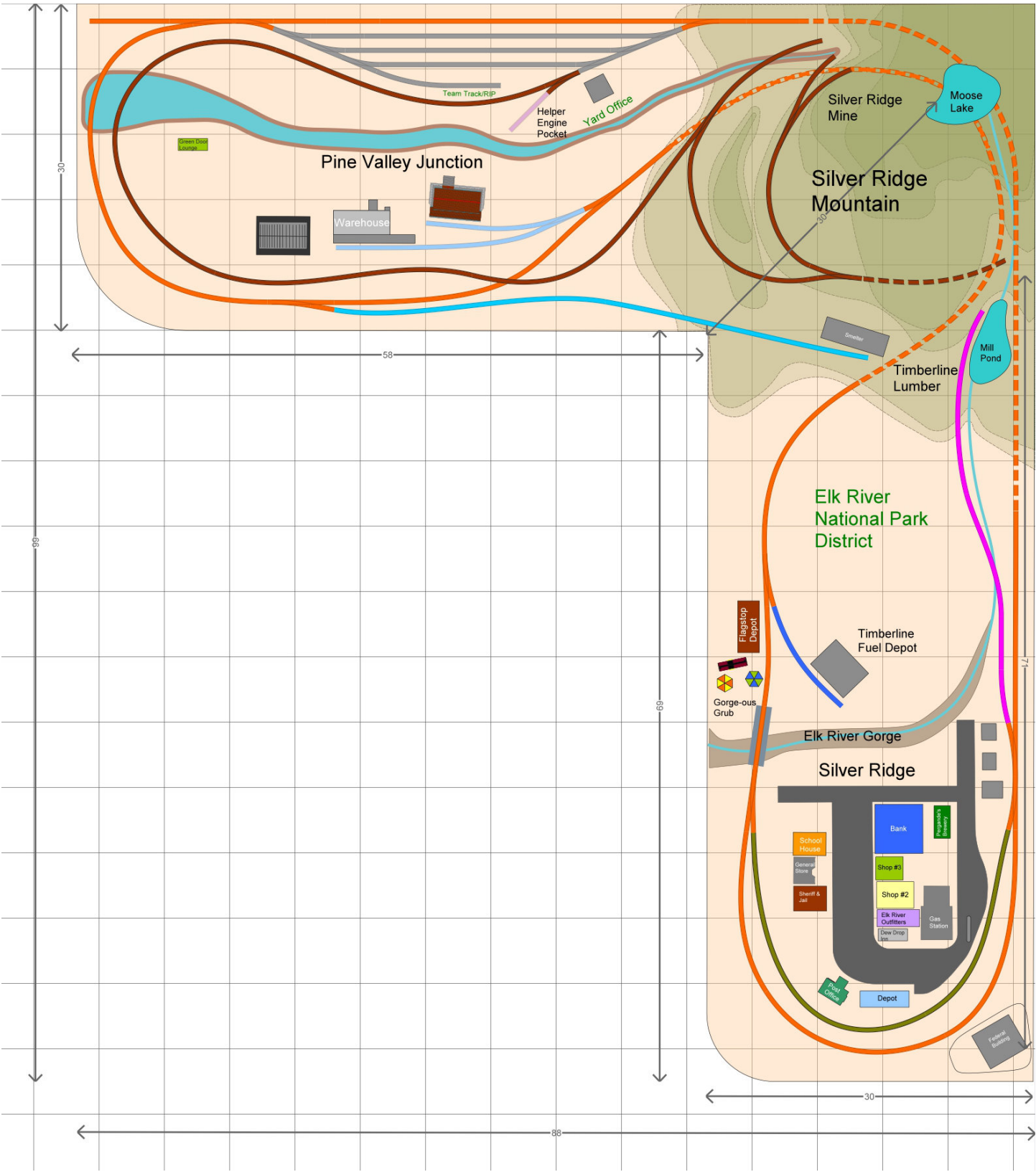
Summer is peak season in every sense — maximum Flyer consists, heaviest tourist traffic, longest days, and the full operational calendar running simultaneously. The National Park District is at its most accessible and most crowded. Early morning and evening light are the photographer's hours; midday in summer is for the tourists.

Autumn is the season the railroad's territory was made for. The larches and aspens on the Timberline grade turn in sequence, working up the elevation as October progresses. Mine traffic increases as the season closes. The Flyer's consist begins to shorten as the tourist season winds down, but the light through the park curves in October afternoon sun is the best light the railroad sees all year. This is when most of the photographs that define the SRRX's public image were taken.

Winter is for the committed. Snow service trains run ahead of scheduled movements after heavy falls, and catching a snow extra on the gorge approach or the mine branch is the kind of photograph that does not come easily. The Flyer runs point-to-point through the winter, its maroon equipment against fresh snow on the Silver Ridge depot platform a reliable image that never quite gets old. Dress for the elevation. The mountain does not make allowances for visitors who came unprepared.

Appendix A Layout Map

The map below shows the complete Silver Ridge Railway track plan, v10.



Appendix B Operating Timetable

The Silver Ridge Railway operates on a condensed timetable designed for single-operator sessions. The Valley Flyer holds priority over all freight movements on both subdivisions. Freight windows are scheduled around Flyer departures and arrivals to prevent conflicts at Pine Valley Junction, the NE tunnels, and Silver Ridge. All times and train numbers below are provisional pending timetable formalization.

B.1. Valley Flyer — Gorge Subdivision

The Valley Flyer operates over the Gorge Subdivision (counterclockwise) in both directions. Departure times reflect fast-clock session time; the conversion ratio is to be established at commissioning.

Westbound — Pine Valley Junction to Silver Ridge

*Train **SRRX**- departs Pine Valley Junction at **00:00**, proceeding via the station spur, inner NE tunnel, National Park District, Timberline Fuel Depot, and Silver Ridge Gorge, arriving Silver Ridge Depot at **00:00**.*

Eastbound — Silver Ridge to Pine Valley Junction

*Train **SRRX**- departs Silver Ridge Depot at **00:00**, returning via the exact reverse of the westbound route, arriving Pine Valley Junction at **00:00**.*

B.2. Freight Operations — River Subdivision

River Run freight operates clockwise: Pine Valley Junction eastbound via the outer NE tunnel, south through Timberline Lumber, arriving Silver Ridge from the east. The River Run freight window opens after the Valley Flyer has cleared PVJ and closes before the Flyer's return.

*Train **SRRX**- departs Pine Valley Junction at **00:00**, works Timberline Lumber, and arrives Silver Ridge at **00:00**.*

B.3. Freight Operations — Mine Run

The Mine Run operates off the north leg, departing PVJ yard and working the Silver Ridge Mine switchback. The mine run is scheduled within the freight window and must clear the north leg before any mainline movement through the NE corner.

*Train **SRRX**- departs PVJ yard at **00:00**, works mine spurs A and B, and returns to PVJ at **00:00**.*

B.4. Freight Operations — Gorge Subdivision

Gorge Subdivision freight serves the Timberline Fuel Depot. This assignment operates only when the Valley Flyer is not occupying the subdivision. Scheduling must account for the Flyer's turnaround time at Silver Ridge.

*Train **SRRX**- departs Pine Valley Junction at **00:00**, works Timberline Fuel Depot, and returns to PVJ at **00:00**.*

B.5. D&RGW Interchange

Interchange cuts are set out and picked up at the NW corner interchange track. Interchange switching is conducted by MoPac #4637 within the PVJ yard limits and does not require a separate train authority. Timing is coordinated with the local freight window.

*Interchange window: **00:00 – 00:00***

B.6. Silver Ridge Town Switching

Silver Ridge yard and depot switching is performed within yard limits by the road locomotive after arrival. No separate authority is required. The team track and depot spur are worked as needed within the turnaround window.

Silver Ridge switching window: 00:00 – 00:00

B.7. Notes

All train numbers, departure times, and arrival times are pending formalization. Fast-clock ratio and session length are to be established at commissioning. Meet points and passing sidings are to be confirmed following track laying and fouling point installation per Section 7.9. This timetable shell is intended as a structural reference only; a completed timetable will be inserted here prior to first full operations session.

Appendix C Waybill Reference and Car Forwarding Guide

This appendix provides the car forwarding reference for all SRRX freight operations. Specific car assignments, commodity designations, and spot numbers are to be completed following track laying, fouling point installation, and fleet decoder commissioning. The two-visit cycle governs all freight car movements; see SECTION 8 for operating procedures by assignment.

C.1. The Two-Visit Cycle

PROSE DESCRIPTION OF THE TWO-VISIT CYCLE AS APPLIED TO SRRX WAYBILL OPERATIONS — HOW CARS ARE SPOTTED ON THE FIRST VISIT AND RETRIEVED ON THE SECOND, AND HOW WAYBILLS ARE ROTATED BETWEEN SESSIONS.

C.2. Industry Spots and Car Assignments

SILVER RIDGE MINE — Spur A (loaded/active) and Spur B (empties). Car types, spot numbers, and commodity designations to be assigned at commissioning.

TIMBERLINE LUMBER — single spur, second spot pending construction. Car types and commodity designations to be assigned at commissioning.

TIMBERLINE FUEL DEPOT — primary and secondary tank car spots. Car assignments and spot numbers to be confirmed at commissioning.

SILVER SMELTER — tank car spots. Car assignments and spot numbers to be confirmed at commissioning.

SILVER RIDGE DEPOT TEAM TRACK — general freight. Configuration and spot numbers pending construction.

DEGRW INTERCHANGE — inbound and outbound car designations to be established following interchange track confirmation at construction.

C.3. Waybill Format and Rotation

DESCRIPTION OF PHYSICAL OR DIGITAL WAYBILL format used on the SRRX, and the session-to-session rotation procedure.

C.4. Car Forwarding Reference

MASTER CAR FORWARDING TABLE — one entry per car: reporting marks, car type, assigned industry, spot number, commodity, and load state. To be completed at commissioning.

Appendix D SRRX Logo and Colors

This appendix provides the official color palette and logo variants for the Silver Ridge Railway. These standards govern locomotive paint, rolling stock lettering, signage, and all printed and digital materials carrying the SRRX identity. Logo image files are to be placed by the publisher in the designated positions below.

D.1. Official Color Palette

- SRRX Maroon** — Hex #5A1F1F.  Applied to locomotive body panels and logo background fields.
- SRRX Cream** — Hex #F2E6C9  Applied to lettering, striping, and herald text on locomotives and passenger equipment.
- Safety Yellow** — Hex #EED202  Applied to handrails, grab irons, and safety markings on all motive power.
- Deep Black** — Hex #000000  Applied to underframes, walkways, and trucks on all equipment.
- Gray** — Hex #A8A8A8  Applied to stenciled reporting marks and data panels on freight cars.

D.2. Logo Variants

The SRRX maintains four logo variants for use across different applications. All variants share the core mountain, treeline, and winding road illustration with SRRX lettering. Selection of the appropriate variant is governed by the surface, scale, and reproduction context.

Warm Gray — *The primary circular badge with maroon field, cream arc text reading Silver Ridge Railway, and Safety Yellow SRRX on a black oval center. Used for official documents, printed materials, and display signage.*



Official Badge — *Shield and oval badge format with maroon field and cream border. Proportioned for application to locomotive cab panels and tender sides.*



Locomotive Variant — *Similar oval shield format, adjusted proportions for freight and passenger car application.*



Rolling Stock Variant — *High-contrast black, white, and maroon treatment for freight car reporting marks and monochrome print contexts.*



Stencil Variant — *Distressed treatment of the Official Badge for use on layout signage, fascia, and scenic detail applications where an aged appearance is appropriate.*

D.3. Decal Sheet

The SRRX decal sheet contains all logo variants at multiple scales, number sets, road marking elements, and reporting mark blocks for fleet application. The sheet is print-ready and is to be inserted below.

D.4. Usage Notes

The SRRX motto — Small Railroad. Big Heart. — is used sparingly and reserved for public-facing materials only. It does not appear on rolling stock or motive power. The motto is never used in operational documentation.

Color matching for physical modeling applications should reference the hex values above as the primary standard. Paint brand equivalents are to be identified by the modeler and are not specified here, as available products vary by supplier and era.



Appendix E Glossary

The following definitions cover operations, equipment, track geography, and SRRX-specific language as used throughout this handbook. Entries reflect the Silver Ridge Railway track plan v10 and canonical naming conventions. General model railroad and DCC terms are included where they appear in operating procedures.

A

- Air Test** — A brake test performed before a train departs a terminal or yard.
- A-B Set** — A paired locomotive consist consisting of a cab-equipped A unit and a cabless B unit.
- Authority** — Permission granted by the dispatcher for a crew to occupy a defined section of track. On the SRRX, authority is issued via track warrant.

B

- B Unit** — A locomotive without an operating cab, designed to work in multiple with an A unit.
- Ballast** — Crushed rock placed beneath and around track ties to support the rail and aid drainage.
- Block** — A defined section of track governed by movement authority.
- Booster District** — An electrically isolated section of layout track fed by its own DCC booster or power district.
- Branchline** — A secondary route diverging from a main line. The SRRX operates as an independent shortline but functions operationally as a branchline connecting Pine Valley Junction to Silver Ridge.

C

- Car Flow** — The planned movement of freight cars between industries across one or more operating sessions. SRRX car flow is governed by the two-visit cycle: cars are spotted, loaded or unloaded, and pulled on a subsequent run.
- Centerbeam** — A flatcar with a central longitudinal spine, used for dimensional lumber loads. Relevant to Timberline Lumber operations.
- Consist** — The locomotives assigned to a train, listed in order from rear to front as seen from the engineer's position. The Valley Flyer consist is fixed: Obs #2780 — Coach #1919 — F9A #215.
- Coupler** — The mechanical device connecting cars and locomotives. The SRRX fleet uses a mix of Rapido-style and knuckle couplers; fleet-wide standardization is a pending project. The observation car carries no rear coupler — this is a permanent constraint.

D

- DCC** — Digital Command Control. The electronic system used to operate SRRX locomotives independently on shared track. The SRRX runs DCC-EX with JMRI and Engine Driver.
- D&RGW** — Denver and Rio Grande Western Railroad. The Class I connection at the SRRX interchange, located in the NW corner of the layout at Pine Valley Junction.

Dispatcher — The person authorizing train movements on the SRRX. In single-operator sessions, the operator serves as both crew and dispatcher.

Double-Heading — Two locomotives pulling from the front of a train.

Drop Feeder — A short wire connecting the rail to the DCC power bus beneath the layout.

E

Engine Driver — Android application used to operate SRRX locomotives wirelessly via the DCC-EX system. A dedicated Android device is required due to wi-fi conflict issues.

Engine Service Track — Track designated for fueling, sanding, or light servicing of locomotives. Location to be confirmed at construction.

EOT Device — End-of-train marker.

F

F9A / F9B — EMD F9 locomotive variants. The A unit carries a full cab; the B unit is cabless. SRRX operates an ATSF Warbonnet A-B set as primary Valley Flyer power. The F9A carries white drive gears and requires an extended run test before entering regular service.

Flex Track — Bendable sectional track used for curves and custom alignments in layout construction.

Fouling Point — The location on a spur or siding beyond which a car will interfere with movements on the adjacent track. Fouling point markers are to be installed at track laying per Section 7.9.

Freight Window — A scheduled period of time during which freight operations may occur without conflicting with Valley Flyer passenger movements. See Appendix A.

G

Gondola — An open-top freight car used for scrap, aggregate, or bulk materials. The SRRX uses an MTL gondola on the River Run for Timberline Lumber service.

Gorge Subdivision — The SRRX operating district covering the Scenic Run route: Pine Valley Junction to Silver Ridge via the National Park District, Timberline Fuel Depot, and Silver Ridge Gorge. Also referred to informally as the Scenic Run.

GP38-2 / GP40 — EMD General Purpose locomotive models. MoPac #4637 is a GP38-2 or GP40 serving as SRRX interchange power, stationed at the interchange track during operating sessions.

Grade — The slope of the track expressed as a percentage. The Silver Ridge Mine spur includes grades of 2.7%, 3.3%, and 2.6% across its three switchback legs.

H

Helper — A locomotive added to a train to assist with steep grades. On the SRRX, No. 98 (70-Ton GE) serves as the primary mine helper.

Helper Engine Pocket — The short siding at Pine Valley Junction where the mine helper locomotive is staged between assignments. Visible on the v10 track plan at the NE end of the PVJ yard.

Hopper — A freight car designed for bulk commodities such as ore or coal, with bottom-discharge doors. Used extensively on the SRRX mine run.

I

Interchange — The track where the SRRX exchanges cars with the D&RGW. Located in the NW corner of the layout. MoPac #4637 is the designated interchange locomotive. Track length and placement to be confirmed at construction.

Industry Spot — A designated car placement location at a specific industry. Each spot has an implied load state: cars are spotted empty for loading or loaded for pickup, depending on the industry.

J

JMRI — Java Model Railroad Interface. The SRRX uses JMRI for DCC throttle management and locomotive roster maintenance. Roster completion is pending decoder installation.

Joint — A physical connection between two sections of rail. On the SRRX, joints on curves are soldered for continuity; expansion gaps are cut on straight sections.

K

Kitbash — The practice of modifying or combining commercial structure kits to produce a unique or site-specific building.

L

Lead Track — A track used to access a yard or spur, allowing switching moves without fouling the mainline.

Loadout — The facility or track position where ore hoppers are filled at the Silver Ridge Mine. Access is via Spur A.

M

Mainline — The primary operating track of the SRRX, connecting Pine Valley Junction to Silver Ridge. The mainline forms a continuous loop with two subdivisions: the River Subdivision (clockwise) and the Gorge Subdivision (counterclockwise).

Mine Run — The operating assignment serving the Silver Ridge Mine. Typically handled by No. 98 alone or with SP #5017 as road power on the approach.

Milepost (MP) — A distance marker along the line. Mileposts appear on the layout map (Appendix A) but are not used in handbook prose.

Momentum — A DCC decoder setting that simulates the mass of a locomotive, producing gradual acceleration and deceleration. Recommended for all SRRX road power.

N

National Park District — The scenic district on the east leg of the layout, traversed by the Gorge Subdivision between the NE tunnels and Timberline Fuel Depot. The Valley Flyer passes through this district on every Scenic Run.

Normal Position — The default alignment of a turnout, typically straight through.

N Scale — 1:160 scale. The modeling scale used for the Silver Ridge Railway.

O

Observation Car — A passenger car with an open or enclosed rear platform for scenic viewing. The SRRX Valley Flyer operates with Obs #2780 at the PVJ end of the consist.

Operations (Ops) — The practice of running model trains according to prototype-inspired procedures: car forwarding, switching assignments, timetable adherence, and crew responsibilities.

P

Pine Valley District — The operating district centered on Pine Valley Junction, encompassing the PVJ yard, interchange, warehouse, and station facilities.

Pine Valley Junction (PVJ) — The western terminal of the SRRX, located in the NW corner of the layout. PVJ includes the yard, station spur, helper engine pocket, warehouse, and D&RGW interchange. The Valley Flyer originates here.

Power District — See Booster District.

R

Reporting Marks — The alphabetic code identifying a railroad or car owner stenciled on freight equipment. SRRX reporting marks appear on company-owned cars.

Reversed Position — A turnout aligned to the diverging route rather than the normal straight-through position.

RIP Track — "Repair In Place" track in PVJ yard used for minor repairs to locomotives and freight cars.

River Subdivision — The SRRX operating district covering the River Run route: Pine Valley Junction eastbound via the outer NE tunnel, south on the east leg through Timberline Lumber, arriving at Silver Ridge from the east.

River Run — See River Subdivision. Used informally to describe clockwise mainline operations.

Road Power — The locomotive(s) assigned to mainline or through freight service, as distinct from a yard switcher. SP #5017 is the designated SRRX road engine pending decoder installation.

Runaround — A track maneuver allowing a locomotive to move from one end of a car or cut to the other. A mainline runaround is available at Silver Ridge.

S

Scenic Run — See Gorge Subdivision. Used informally to describe counterclockwise mainline operations via the gorge.

SD40 — An EMD six-axle road locomotive. SP #5017 is believed to be an SD40 pending underframe inspection.

Silver Ridge Depot — The passenger and freight station at Silver Ridge, located at the south end of the east leg. The Valley Flyer terminates here.

Silver Ridge Gorge — The dramatic gorge scenery on the Gorge Subdivision, south of Timberline Fuel Depot. A viewing platform is planned on the north rim, pending construction.

Silver Ridge Mine — The ore extraction facility at the NE corner of the layout, accessed via a three-leg switchback spur off the north leg. Spur A holds loaded cars; Spur B holds empties.

Silver Ridge National Park District — See National Park District.

Silver Smelter — An industrial facility on the Mine Subdivision, served by tank cars. Located between the NE tunnel exit and Timberline Fuel Depot.

Spur A / Spur B — The two storage tracks at the Silver Ridge Mine. Spur A is used for loaded or active ore cars; Spur B holds empties. Both spurs were added in track plan v10.

Spotting — The act of placing a freight car at a specific industry location for loading or unloading.

Switch / Turnout — A track device that allows a train to move from one track to another. Used interchangeably in this handbook.

Switchback — A reversing track arrangement used to gain elevation or access a location unreachable by a direct approach. The Silver Ridge Mine spur uses a three-leg switchback.

T

Team Track — A publicly accessible track at a depot or yard where local businesses can load or unload freight cars without a private industry spur. The Silver Ridge Depot includes a team track; extended track or a second spur is pending construction.

Timberline District — The operating district on the east leg encompassing Timberline Lumber and Timberline Fuel Depot.

Timberline Fuel Depot — The fuel distribution facility on the Gorge Subdivision, North of the gorge. Served by tank cars including the Shell primary and Dow/Hooker secondary cars.

Timberline Lumber — The lumber industry on the River Subdivision, served by the River Run freight assignment. Currently served by a single spur; a second spot is pending construction confirmation.

Track Warrant — A dispatcher-issued written or verbal authority granting a crew the right to occupy a specific section of track during a defined time window.

Two-Visit Cycle — The SRRX car forwarding convention in which a freight car requires two separate operating sessions to complete a spot: it is placed empty on the first visit and retrieved loaded (or vice versa) on the second.

Tunnel — The SRRX has two tunnels at the NE corner of the layout. The outer tunnel carries the River Subdivision; the inner tunnel carries the Gorge Subdivision.

U

Uncoupling — The separation of two cars or a car and locomotive. Performed manually or with a magnetic uncoupling ramp depending on coupler type.

Underframe — The structural base of a freight car, including bolsters, center sill, and truck mounting points. SP #5017 requires an underframe check to confirm locomotive model and decoder compatibility.

V

Valley Flyer — The SRRX named passenger train operating between Pine Valley Junction and Silver Ridge via the Gorge Subdivision. Consist is fixed: Obs #2780 — Coach #1919 — F9A #215. The Valley Flyer has priority over all freight movements.

W

Waybill — A document describing a freight car's origin, destination, commodity, and routing. SRRX waybills are the primary car forwarding tool. See Appendix C.

Weathering — Painting and finishing techniques applied to models to simulate age, wear, and environmental exposure.

Wye — A triangular track arrangement used to turn locomotives or entire trains. The SRRX does not have a wye; turning is not required in normal operations.

Y

Yard — A facility with multiple tracks for sorting, storing, and assembling cars. Pine Valley Junction contains the primary SRRX yard.

Yard Limits — The defined boundary of a yard within which yard crews may move without track warrant authority.

Yard Office — The administrative structure at the PVJ yard.

Appendix F SRRX Fleet Roster

This appendix lists all motive power and rolling stock assigned to the Silver Ridge Railway. Decoder addresses, sound profiles, and JMRI roster entries are to be completed following decoder installation and commissioning. Entries marked as pending reflect equipment awaiting DCC conversion or mechanical assessment.

F.1. Motive Power

No. 98 — 70-Ton GE, L&N — DCC operational. Primary yard switcher and mine helper. Capable of independent mine run. Decoder address: *98*.

44-Ton GE, red/gold — DCC installed, bad gears, untested. Status: *[ASSESS AND CONFIRM SERVICEABILITY]*.

SP #5017 — EMD GP-30 — DC, decoder candidate. Good runner. Primary road engine and mine run power pending DCC conversion. Underframe inspection required to confirm model. Decoder address: *5017*.

MoPac #4637 — GEB23-7 — DC, decoder candidate. Designated interchange power. Stationed at interchange track during operating sessions. Decoder address: *4637*.

Santa Fe F9A #215 — Warbonnet — DC, decoder candidate. Primary Valley Flyer power. White drive gears — extended run test required before regular service. Decoder address: *215 (if DCC capable)*.

Santa Fe F9B #215 — Warbonnet — Dummy unit. When in service, it is coupled to F9A #215 as Valley Flyer A-B set. No decoder required.

SP #9725 — Dummy unit. Pairs with SP #5017 as needed.

F.2. Project and Assessment Locomotives

The following locomotives are not currently in service and require assessment or restoration before assignment.

ATSF F9A #215 bundle — Parts donor or restoration candidate. Assess against primary F9A #215 needs before committing to either role.

ATSF #3500 — GP30(?), bluebonnet — Missing wheels and hood. Full assessment required before any assignment.

SCL #6678 — GP38(?) — Missing parts. Full assessment required before any assignment.

F.3. Display Equipment

PRR Tender — Static display only. Designated for PVJ yard or mine entrance. Not operable.

F.4. Passenger Equipment

Observation Car Obs #2780 — Model Power standard — Valley Flyer consist, PVJ end. Metal wheels, isolated opposite rails front and rear — track power lighting feasible. Rapido-style truck-mounted couplers.

Coach #1919 — Model Power standard — Valley Flyer consist. Plastic wheels — metal wheelset replacement required before lighting installation. Rapido-style truck-mounted couplers.

F.5. Freight Equipment

Mine Run — Ore and Hopper Cars

BN ore car, Thunder Bay ore car #798, PRR hopper, B&O hopper. Fleet coupler standardization strategy pending.

River Run — Timberline Lumber

MTL gondola — primary Timberline Lumber car.

River Run — Timberline Lumber

Shell tank car (primary spot), Dow/Hooker tank car (secondary spot).

Scenic Run — Timberline Fuel Depot

Hooker tank car, Dow tank car, Penn Salt tank car.

Mine Run — Silver Smelter

Burlington hopper, Swift reefer, Lehigh Valley boxcar.

F.6. Equipment Needed

The following cars are on the SRRX acquisition list and have not yet been received. Assignments are provisional pending availability and coupler compatibility.

Baggage-express car (priority), two additional ore cars, PFE reefer, second stock car, mineral hopper.

F.7. JMRI Roster

[FULL JMRI ROSTER to be inserted here following decoder installation and commissioning. include: road number, decoder brand and model, address, speed steps, motor type, sound profile, and any consist configuration.]

